National Comprehensive Cancer Network®

NCCN Clinical Practice Guidelines in Oncology (NCCN Guidelines®)

# Histiocytic Neoplasms

Version 2.2026 — July 15, 2026

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# NCCN Guidelines Version 2.2026
# Histiocytic Neoplasms

NCCN Guidelines Index
Table of Contents
Discussion

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# NCCN Guidelines Version 2.2026
# Histiocytic Neoplasms

NCCN Guidelines Index
Table of Contents
Discussion

NCCN Histiocytic Neoplasms Panel Members
Summary of the Guidelines Updates

Adult Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis:
- Workup/Evaluation (ADULCH-1)
- Tissue Biopsy Analysis for LCH (ADULCH-1A)
- Unifocal LCH Not Involving Critical Organs (ADULCH-2)
- Multisystem or Multifocal Single-System LCH or Unifocal LCH Involving Critical Organs (ADULCH-3)
- Follow-Up, Treatment for Relapsed/Refractory Disease (ADULCH-4)
- Response Criteria (ADULCH-4A)

Pediatric Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis:
- Workup/Evaluation (PEDLCH-1)
- Tissue Biopsy Analysis for LCH (PEDLCH-1A)
- Unifocal LCH (PEDLCH-2)
- Multisystem LCH or Unifocal LCH that Progresses on Local Therapy or Unifocal LCH Involving Critical Organs (PEDLCH-3)
- Follow-Up, Treatment for Relapsed/Refractory Disease (PEDLCH-4)

Erdheim-Chester Disease:
- Workup/Evaluation (ECD-1)
- Tissue Biopsy Analysis for ECD (ECD-1A)
- Presentation (ECD-2)

Rosai-Dorfman Disease:
- Workup/Evaluation (RDD-1)
- Tissue Biopsy Analysis for RDD (RDD-1A)
- Unifocal/Multifocal RDD (RDD-2)

Malignant Histiocytic Neoplasms:
- Workup/Evaluation (MHN-1)
- Tissue Biopsy Analysis for Malignant Histiocytic Neoplasms (MHN-1A)
- Primary MHN/Secondary MHN (MHN-2)
- Secondary MHN or Concomitant Hematologic Neoplasm (MHN-3)
- Follow-Up, Treatment for Relapsed/Refractory Disease (MHN-4)

Principles of Diagnostic Evaluation (HIST-A)
Characteristic Features of Histiocytic Neoplasms (HIST-B)
Principles of Pathology (HIST-C)
Principles of Systemic Therapy (HIST-D)
Principles of Supportive Care (HIST-E)
Principles of Targeted Therapy (HIST-F)
Principles of Radiation Therapy (HIST-G)
Principles of Molecular Testing (HIST-H)

Abbreviations (ABBR-1)

Find an NCCN Member Institution: https://www.nccn.org/home/member-institutions.

**NCCN Categories of Evidence and Consensus:** All recommendations are category 2A unless otherwise indicated.

See NCCN Categories of Evidence and Consensus.

**NCCN Categories of Preference:** All recommendations are considered appropriate.

See NCCN Categories of Preference.

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# NCCN Guidelines Version 2.2026
# Histiocytic Neoplasms



**Updates in Version 2.2026 of the NCCN Guidelines for Histiocytic Neoplasms:**

**Global**
• NTRK1/2/3 revised to NTRK1.

**New Section**
• Principles of Molecular Testing (HIST-H 1 of 3)

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**Updates in Version 1.2026 of the NCCN Guidelines for Histiocytic Neoplasms include:**

**Global**
• References updated throughout the guideline.

**New Pages**
• Radiographic Response Criteria for Adults with LCH (ADULCH-4A)
• Key Features of LCH (HIST-A 1)
• Key Features of ECD (HIST-A 2)
• Key Features of RDD (HIST-A 3)

**New Algorithm, Summary of Pathologic and Molecular Features, and Principles of Systemic Therapy**
• Malignant Histiocytic Neoplasms (MHN-1, HIST-C 5, and HIST-D 6)

**Adult Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis**
ADULCH-1
• Essential, 6th bullet added: MRI of the brain with and without contrast (Also for ECD-1 and RDD-1)
• Useful Under Certain Circumstances, Based on Symptoms or Organ Involvement, 2nd bullet, 1st sub-bullet removed: brain. (Also for ECD-1 and RDD-1)
• Algorithm pathways revised:
  ▸ ~~Uncomplicated~~ Unifocal LCH *not involving critical organs (ie, CNS, liver, spleen)* (Also for ADULCH-2)
  ▸ Multisystem or multifocal single-system LCH or ~~Unifocal LCH that progresses on local therapy or~~ Unifocal LCH involving critical organs (ie, central nervous system [CNS], liver, spleen) (Also for ADULCH-3)
• Footnote a added: Refer to the NCCN Distress Thermometer and Problem List, which includes social determinants of health. See NCCN Guidelines for Distress Management (DIS-A). (Also for PEDLCH-1, ECD-1, and RDD-1)
• Footnote d revised: Common sites of involvement include: bone, CNS, lung, lymph node, skin, and spleen~~ bone marrow, gastrointestinal (GI) system, liver, oral mucosa~~. See Characteristic Features of Histiocytic Neoplasms (HIST-B).

Continued
UPDATES

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**Updates in Version 1.2026 of the NCCN Guidelines for Histiocytic Neoplasms include:**

**Adult Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis (continued)**

ADULCH-1A

- Molecular testing, 2nd sub-bullet revised: ~~Gene fusion assay~~ *RNA-based NGS to detect gene fusions* (Also for PEDLCH-1A, ECD-1A, and RDD-1A)
- Footnote removed: At minimum, the IHC panel recommended should include CD1a, S100, and Langerin; cyclin D1 and BRAF V600E (VE1, preferred antibody if possible). (Also for PEDLCH-1A)
- Footnote i revised: "... Targeted NGS panel testing should cover the common somatic mutations involving the MAPK pathway *(ie, BRAF, ARAF, NRAS, KRAS, MAP2K1/2) and other related pathway mutations (eg, PIK3CA, CSF1R)*. RNA-based molecular panel including fusion testing should cover BRAF, ALK, RET, and NTRK1 rearrangements. ~~If there is clinical concern for ALK-positive histiocytosis, ALK IHC and fluorescence in situ hybridization (FISH) using ALK break-apart probe should be performed.~~ *If ALK IHC is positive, the presence of a rearrangement should be confirmed molecularly (eg, by fluorescence in situ hybridization [FISH] or RNA sequencing).* (Also for PEDLCH-1A and ECD-1A)
- Footnote j revised: Fresh or paraffin-embedded tissue is used for NGS study; peripheral blood may be informative in multisystem disease. ~~The NGS panel should cover the common MAPK pathway mutations (ie, BRAF, ARAF, NRAS, KRAS, MAP2K1/2) and other related pathway mutations (eg, PIK3CA, CSF1R).~~ (Also for PEDLCH-1A and ECD-1A)

ADULCH-2

- Page extensively revised.

ADULCH-3

- Footnote p revised: Provide resources for ~~smoking~~ cessation *of smoking* (see NCCN Guidelines for Smoking Cessation) *and cannabis use (Fabozzi A, et al. BMC Pulm Med 2025;25:44).* (Also for HIST-A 4)

ADULCH-4

- Treatment response assessment, Imaging of involved sites, 1st bullet revised: FDG-PET/CT scan vertex to toes (preferred) or contrast-enhanced CT/MRI *as indicated by the initial organ of involvement*
- Surveillance of patients on observation or in remission, 2nd bullet revised: Imaging: FDG-PET/CT scan vertex to toes (preferred) or contrast-enhanced CT/MRI *as indicated by the initial organ of involvement*
- Footnote r added: For radiographic response criteria, see ADULCH-4A.

**Pediatric Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis**

PEDLCH-2

- Footnote k revised: Sentinel lymph node changes (enlargement, hypermetabolic activity on FDG-PET~~/CT~~ *imaging*) should not be regarded as another system involved, unless histologically confirmed by lymph node biopsy (CD1a+ histiocytes, characteristic immuno-architecture).
- Footnote q revised: Provide resources for ~~smoking~~ cessation *of smoking* (see NCCN Guidelines for Smoking Cessation) *and cannabis use (Fabozzi A, et al. BMC Pulm Med 2025;25:44), if applicable.*
- Footnote r added: Principles of Radiation Therapy (HIST-G).

PEDLCH-4

- Surveillance of patients on observation or in remission, 3rd bullet revised: "Annual ~~contrast-enhanced~~ brain MRI *with and without contrast..."*

Continued
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**Updates in Version 1.2026 of the NCCN Guidelines for Histiocytic Neoplasms include:**

## Erdheim-Chester Disease

ECD-2

- Follow-up, 5th bullet revised: ~~Perform bone marrow biopsy as indicated~~ *Bone marrow evaluation in the presence of unexplained CBC abnormality (to rule out hemophagocytic lymphohistiocytosis, ECD, and/or associated myeloid neoplasm)*
- Relapsed/Refractory Disease, 2nd bullet added: Palliative RT
- Footnote n added: Principles of Radiation Therapy (HIST-G).

## Rosai-Dorfman Disease

RDD-1A

- Molecular testing:
  - 1st bullet revised: Target capture, NGS study including ~~BRAF V600E,~~ MAPK, and related pathway mutations on tissue
  - 3rd bullet revised: Germline mutations (~~optional~~ *familial cases*)
- Footnote h revised: ~~At minimum, the IHC panel recommended should include CD68 or CD163, S100, CD1a; cyclin D1 and BRAF V600E (VE1, preferred antibody if possible).~~ Of caution, cyclin D1 could also be positive or detected in concurrent lymphocytic or histiocytic neoplasm. VE1 is the preferred antibody for BRAF V600E testing if possible. A novel study showed that OCT2 IHC might be helpful, if clinically indicated, in select cases to confirm a suspected diagnosis of RDD, together with other common diagnostic markers. Ravindran A, et al. Am J Surg Pathol 2021;45:35-44.
- Footnote i added: Molecular testing for somatic mutations and fusions can be performed in a stepwise manner or in parallel, depending on clinical need and institutional protocols. The frequency of suspected molecular lesions should drive the order of testing if a stepwise algorithm is chosen. Allele-specific PCR for BRAF V600E mutations can be the first step if BRAF V600E (VE1) IHC is not available or is equivocal. Targeted NGS panel testing should cover the common somatic mutations involving the MAPK pathway (ie, BRAF, ARAF, NRAS, KRAS, MAP2K1/2) and other related pathway mutations (eg, PIK3CA, CSF1R). RNA-based molecular panel including fusion testing should cover BRAF, ALK, RET, and NTRK1 rearrangements.If ALK IHC is positive, the presence of a rearrangement should be confirmed molecularly (eg, by FISH or RNA sequencing).
- Footnote j added: Fresh or paraffin-embedded tissue is used for the NGS study; peripheral blood testing may be informative in multisystem disease. If clinically indicated in cases without the usual MAPK pathway mutations, FISH for BRAF, ALK, RET, or NTRK1 fusions may be performed.
- Footnote removed: NGS sequencing studies are performed if clinically indicated, which may reveal mutations in the MAPK pathway (eg, KRAS, MAP2K1/2) with or without additional somatic mutations also seen in myeloid neoplasia.

RDD-2

- Multifocal RDD, Symptomatic pathway, 2nd bullet revised: Palliative RT *for symptomatic disease not responsive to systemic therapy* ~~(for large tumors with CNS, ocular, or internal organ involvement)~~
- Footnote l added: Principles of Supportive Care (HIST-E).
- Footnote m added: Principles of Radiation Therapy (HIST-G).

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**Updates in Version 1.2026 of the NCCN Guidelines for Histiocytic Neoplasms include:**

## Principles of Diagnostic Evaluation

• Medical History and Physical Examination page removed.

HIST-A 4 of 4

• Laboratory Evaluation
  ▸ 5th bullet added: For LCH and ECD, endocrine panel including the following.
• 7th bullet revised: Bone marrow aspirate/biopsy *in the presence of unexplained CBC abnormalities (ie, unexplained anemia or cytopenias)*
• Footnote c added: Makras P, et al. J Clin Endocrinol Metab 2025;110:1756-1766.
• Footnote removed: Principles of Supportive Care (HIST-E).

## Characteristic Features of Histiocytic Neoplasms

HIST-B 1 of 2

• LCH column, Nervous system row revised: MRI with globus pallidus/dentate nucleus T1 hyperintensity; brainstem/cerebellum T2 hyperintensity; dural lesion from intracranial extension of skull lesion; pituitary stalk thickening*; disappearance of the posterior pituitary bright spot*.

HIST-B 2 of 2

• Table revised:
  ▸ ECD column, Lymph nodes row: ~~Never~~ *Rarely* reported.
  ▸ LCH column, Orbits row: ~~Never~~ *Rarely* reported.

## Principles of Pathology

HIST-C 1 of 6

• General Principles
  ▸ Bullet removed: ALK IHC may be considered, as ALK+ histiocytosis may carry a targetable ALK rearrangement.
  ▸ 6th bullet revised: "...RNA-based molecular panel fusion testing should cover BRAF, ALK, RET, and NTRK1 rearrangements. ~~If there is clinical concern for ALK rearrangement, or if fusion panel testing is not available, ALK IHC and fluorescence in situ hybridization (FISH) studies may be performed.~~ *If ALK IHC is positive, the presence of a rearrangement should be confirmed molecularly (eg, by FISH or RNA sequencing). Repeat molecular testing in negative cases, potentially using a different tissue sample.*
• Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis
  ▸ Bullet removed: Langerhans cells show immunoreactivity for S100, CD1a, and Langerin (CD207).
  ▸ 3rd bullet revised: Reactive Langerhans cell infiltrates *such as dermatopathic lymphadenopathy* may mimic LCH~~; by IHC, expression of cyclin D1 (BCL1) and BRAF V600E (VE1 clone) support LCH.14 VE1 staining is not 100% sensitive or specific, and concurrent molecular testing is recommended~~.
  ▸ 4th bullet added: Langerhans cells show immunoreactivity for S100, CD1a, Langerin (CD207) and cyclin D1 (BCL1) and, in BRAF V600E mutated cases, BRAF V600E (VE1 clone) supports LCH.14 VE1 staining is not 100% sensitive or specific; to avoid false-positive results, unequivocal VE1 staining of 2+ intensity in ≥10% neoplastic histiocytes is required, and concurrent molecular testing is recommended.
  ▸ 5th bullet revised: "Activating signaling pathway mutations found in LCH include BRAF V600E *(approximately 50%)*, BRAF indels *(32%)*..."
  ▸ Bullet added: Suspected bone marrow involvement should be assessed by immunohistochemistry with concurrent molecular testing recommended.

Continued
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**Updates in Version 1.2026 of the NCCN Guidelines for Histiocytic Neoplasms include:**

**Principles of Pathology (continued)**

HIST-C 2 of 6

- Erdheim-Chester Disease
  - 1st bullet revised: "...In the retroperitoneum, findings are usually xanthomatous but sometimes extensively fibrotic~~, and can be associated with increased IgG4+ plasma cells meeting criteria for IgG4-related disease~~..."
  - 3rd bullet revised: "...BRAF V600E mutation has been detected in about 50% of patients with ECD. Kinase fusions (ie, BRAF, ALK, RET, NTRK1) and CSF1R mutations have been reported rarely as well. ~~The revised histiocytic classification recommends classification of all "JXG" with activating MAPK pathway mutations (BRAF, NRAS, KRAS, MAP2K1/2) as ECD.~~"
- Malignant Histiocytic Neoplasms header and 1st through 6th bullets added:
  - Epithelioid to spindle-shaped cells with nuclear atypia
  - Cytologically atypical nuclear features, abundant cytoplasm
  - May have inflammatory background and/or admixed hematolymphoid neoplasm
  - Localized or disseminated mass lesions involving lymph nodes, spleen, and a variety of extranodal sites
  - Malignant histiocytic neoplasms pose a diagnostic challenge due to overlap with other more common aggressive malignancies ranging from acute myeloid leukemia to malignant melanoma, and are a diagnosis of exclusion. They may also co-present or sequentially present with clonally related hematolymphoid neoplasms, most commonly lymphomas
  - See Summary of Pathologic and Molecular Features of Histiocytic Neoplasms for malignant histiocytic neoplasms (HIST-C 5 of 6)

**Principles of Systemic Therapy**

HIST-D 1 of 10

- Multisystem or single-system pulmonary LCH, Useful in Certain Circumstances, regimen added: Tovorafenib for BRAF alterations

HIST-D 3 of 10

- Footnote c added: Principles of Targeted Therapy (HIST-F)

HIST-D 5 of 10

- Preferred, Irrespective of mutation, regimen added: Lenalidomide ± Dexamethasone
- Other Recommended, Irrespective of mutation, regimen removed: Lenalidomide
- Footnote h revised: An FDA-approved biosimilar is an appropriate substitute for ~~rituximab~~ *any recommended systemic biologic therapy in the NCCN Guidelines.*

**Principles of Radiation Therapy**

HIST-G 2 of 2

- Page extensively revised.



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## INTRODUCTION

**These Guidelines describe treatment recommendations for adults and children with histiocytic neoplasms. In scenarios where there is little evidence in the adult population, recommendations are extrapolated from pediatric studies.**

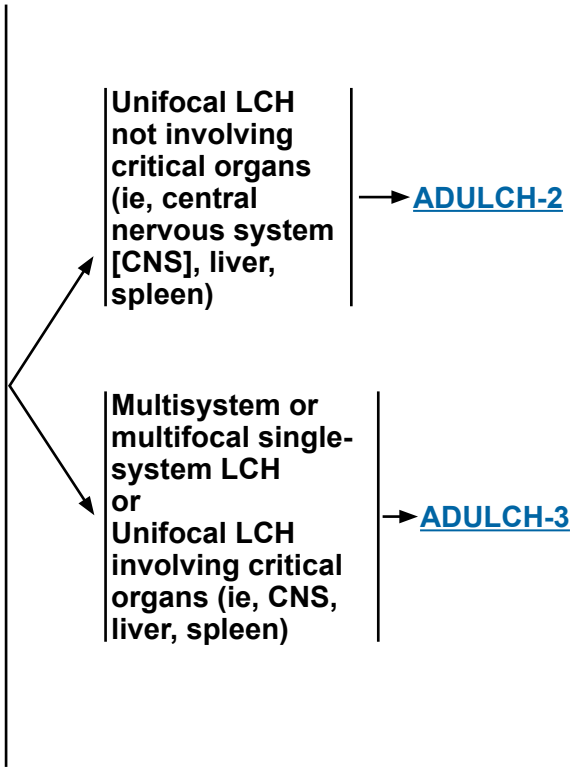
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## WORKUP / EVALUATION[a,b]

**ESSENTIAL:**
- History and physical examination (H&P)[c] with attention to common sites of involvement[d]
- Whole-body fluorodeoxyglucose (FDG)-PET/CT scan including distal extremities (vertex to toes)
- Pulmonary function tests (PFTs) and high-resolution CT (HRCT) of the chest for suspected pulmonary Langerhans cell histiocytosis (LCH)
- Laboratory evaluation[c]
  - If unexplained complete blood count (CBC) abnormality, consider bone marrow biopsy to assess for hemophagocytic lymphohistiocytosis, LCH, and/or associated myeloid neoplasm[e]
- Tissue biopsy[f] (ADULCH-1A)
- MRI of the brain with and without contrast

**USEFUL UNDER CERTAIN CIRCUMSTANCES, BASED ON SYMPTOMS OR ORGAN INVOLVEMENT:**
- CT of the chest, abdomen, and pelvis with contrast
- MRI with and without contrast for the following:
  - spine
  - sella turcica ± pituitary (if arginine vasopressin [AVP] deficiency[g] suspected)
- Right heart catheterization if pulmonary hypertension is suspected
- Transthoracic echocardiogram (TTE) especially for pulmonary LCH
- Ultrasound (US) of the abdomen (liver/spleen)
- Endoscopic retrograde cholangiopancreatography (ERCP) (if liver function tests [LFTs] abnormal or ducts dilated on CT/US)
- Endocrine evaluation (essential in detected endocrinopathy or in cases of pituitary/hypothalamic involvement)
- Digital panoramic x-ray




[a] Refer to the NCCN Distress Thermometer and Problem List, which includes social determinants of health. See NCCN Guidelines for Distress Management (DIS-A).
[b] Adapted with permission from Goyal G, et al. Blood 2022;139:2601-2621.
[c] Principles of Diagnostic Evaluation (HIST-A).
[d] Common sites of involvement include: bone, CNS, lung, lymph node, skin, and spleen. See Characteristic Features of Histiocytic Neoplasms (HIST-B).
[e] See NCCN Guidelines for Myelodysplastic Syndromes or NCCN Guidelines for Myeloproliferative Neoplasms.
[f] Principles of Pathology (HIST-C).
[g] Previously known as diabetes insipidus.

**Note: All recommendations are category 2A unless otherwise indicated.**

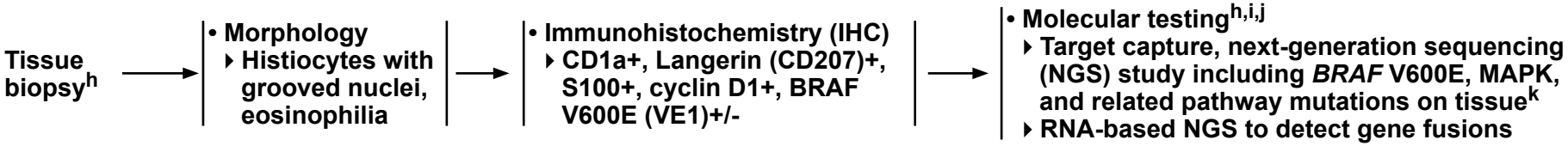


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## TISSUE BIOPSY ANALYSIS FOR LCH




Immunophenotype key: +/-: positive or negative; +: positive; -: negative

[h] For patients with suspected LCH or histiocytosis and biopsy is not possible because of location or risk factors, mutational analysis of the peripheral blood is an option.
[i] Molecular testing for somatic mutations and fusions can be performed in a stepwise manner or in parallel, depending on clinical need and institutional protocols. The frequency of suspected molecular lesions should drive the order of testing if a stepwise algorithm is chosen. Allele-specific polymerase chain reaction (PCR) for *BRAF* V600E mutations can be the first step if BRAF V600E (VE1) IHC is not available or is equivocal. Targeted NGS panel testing should cover the common somatic mutations involving the MAPK pathway (ie, *BRAF, ARAF, NRAS, KRAS, MAP2K1/2*) and other related pathway mutations (eg, *PIK3CA, CSF1R*). RNA-based molecular panel including fusion testing should cover *BRAF*, *ALK*, *RET,* and *NTRK1* rearrangements. If ALK IHC is positive, the presence of a rearrangement should be confirmed molecularly (eg, by fluorescence in situ hybridization [FISH] or RNA sequencing).
[j] Principles of Molecular Testing (HIST-H).
[k] Fresh or paraffin-embedded tissue is used for NGS study; peripheral blood may be informative in multisystem disease.

**Note: All recommendations are category 2A unless otherwise indicated.**



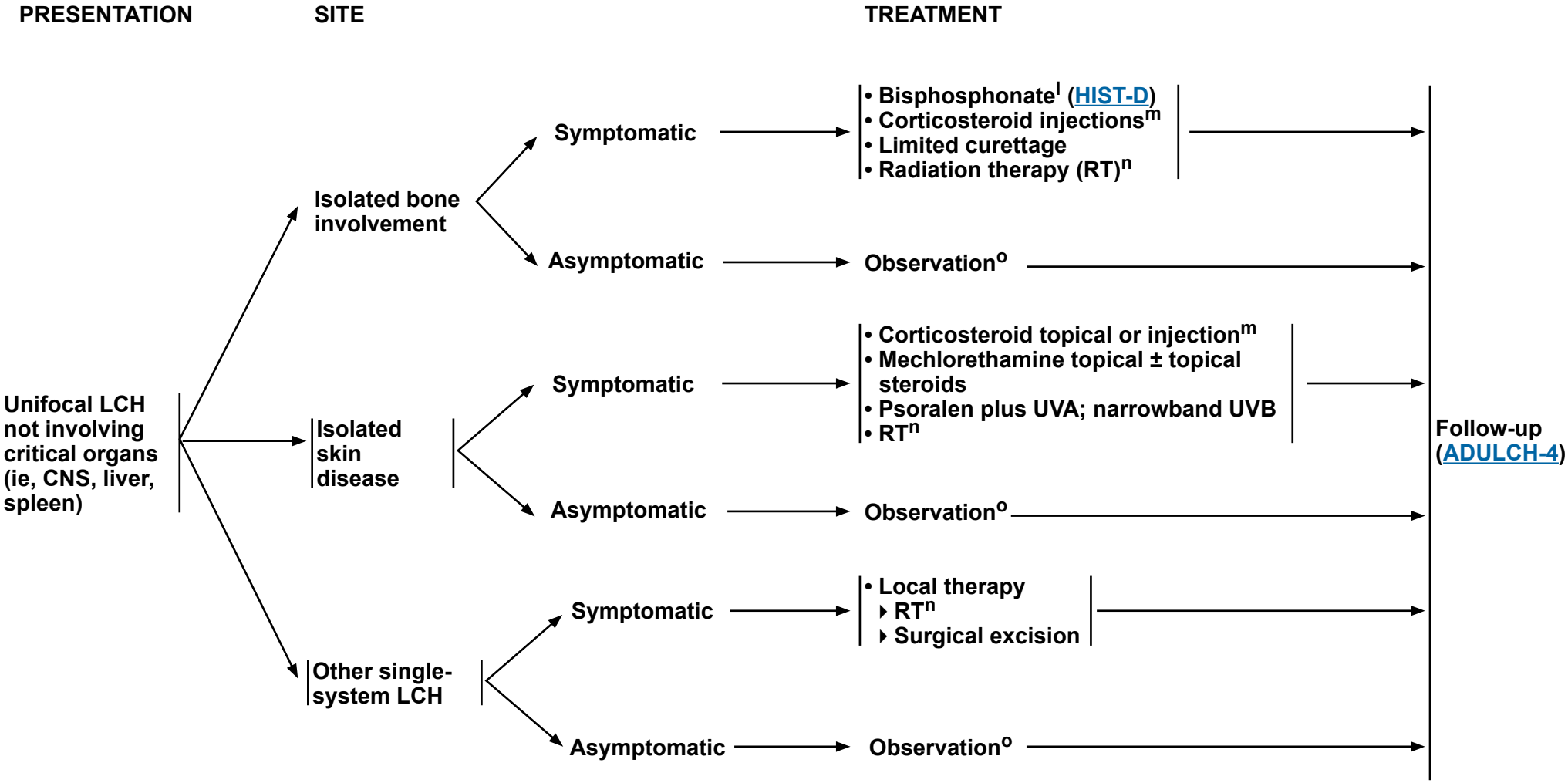
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# NCCN Guidelines Version 2.2026
# Adult Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis

NCCN Guidelines Index
Table of Contents
Discussion




[l] Bone lesions not amenable to local therapies due to size and location.
[m] Triamcinolone injection or equivalent corticosteroid.
[n] Principles of Radiation Therapy (HIST-G).
[o] If patient becomes symptomatic, refer to symptomatic pathway for treatment recommendations.

**Note: All recommendations are category 2A unless otherwise indicated.**



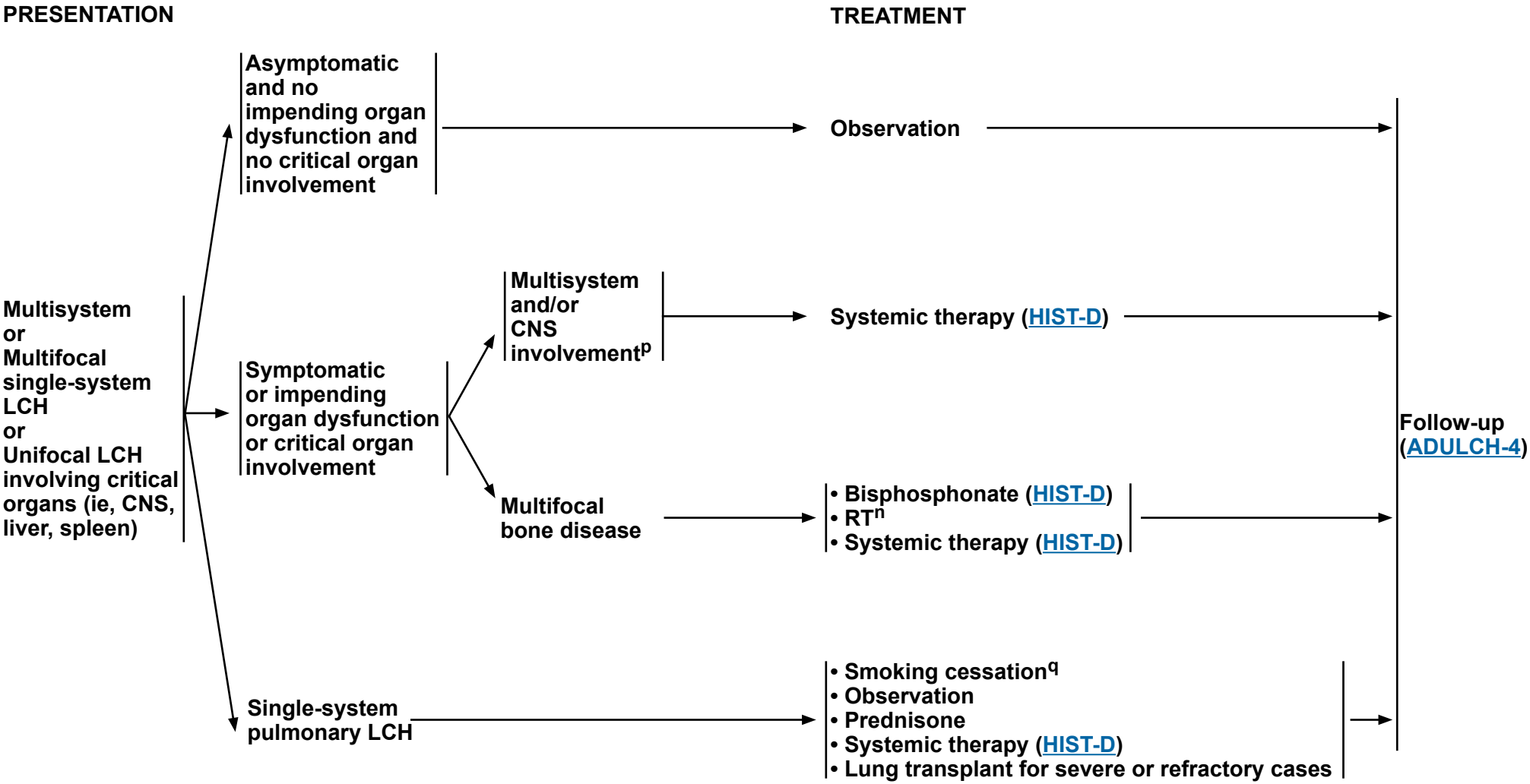
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# NCCN Guidelines Version 2.2026
# Adult Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis

NCCN Guidelines Index
Table of Contents
Discussion




[n] Principles of Radiation Therapy (HIST-G).
[p] For neurodegenerative LCH, clinical findings may not be accompanied by imaging changes. Cognitive symptoms should be carefully evaluated and monitored, and early treatment should be considered if cognitive decline is evident.
[q] Provide resources for cessation of smoking (see NCCN Guidelines for Smoking Cessation) and cannabis use (Fabozzi A, et al. BMC Pulm Med 2025;25:44).

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## FOLLOW-UP[r]

**Treatment response assessment**

**Imaging of involved sites**

- FDG-PET/CT scan vertex to toes (preferred) or contrast-enhanced CT/MRI as indicated by the initial organ of involvement[s]
  - After 2–3 cycles of systemic therapy and at completion
  - After completion of surgical curettage
  - After RT[n]

**Surveillance of patients on observation or in remission**

- H&P and labs at least annually or more frequently as clinically indicated
- Imaging: FDG-PET/CT scan vertex to toes (preferred) or contrast-enhanced CT/MRI as indicated by the initial organ of involvement[s]
  - No more than every 6 months for up to 2 years post completion of treatment
  - >2 years: no more than annually
  - For patients who are asymptomatic with a single-site bone lesion, imaging surveillance can potentially end after year 1, with continued tracking of symptoms
- Monitor PFTs every 6–12 months for up to 2 years for pulmonary LCH with further follow-up as clinically indicated
- Bone marrow evaluation in the presence of unexplained CBC abnormality (to rule out hemophagocytic lymphohistiocytosis, LCH, and/or associated myeloid neoplasm)
- For patients with:
  - BRAF inhibitors, regular skin examination and echocardiogram[t]
  - MEK inhibitors, regular skin examination, retinal examination, and echocardiogram[t]
  - Monitor every 1–2 years for pituitary hormone abnormalities

## TREATMENT FOR RELAPSED/ REFRACTORY DISEASE

- Systemic therapy (HIST-D)
- If duration of response >1 year, consider same regimen; otherwise use a regimen not used for first-line therapy

→ See NCCN Guidelines for Survivorship

[n] Principles of Radiation Therapy (HIST-G).
[r] Principles of Supportive Care (HIST-E).
[s] For radiographic response criteria, see ADULCH-4A.
[t] Principles of Targeted Therapy (HIST-F).

**Note: All recommendations are category 2A unless otherwise indicated.**



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## RESPONSE CRITERIA

**Radiographic Response Criteria for Adults with LCH[1]**

| Response Category[u] | Radiographic Response Criteria (FDG-PET) | Radiographic Response Criteria (CT or MRI) |
|---|---|---|
| Complete response | Normalization of lesions with FDG uptake equal to surrounding background tissue | Complete anatomic resolution of lesions or resolution of abnormal imaging features (enhancement, diffusion restriction, etc)[v] |
| Partial response | Reduction from baseline standardized uptake value (SUV) of lesions, but persistent uptake greater than surrounding background tissue | Reduction, but not complete resolution of lesions/abnormal imaging features |
| Progressive disease | Increased SUV value of lesions as compared with before or appearance of new FDG avid lesions | Worsening of abnormal imaging features or growth of existing lesions or appearance of new lesions |
| Stable disease | Does not meet other criteria | Does not meet other criteria |

[1] Adapted with permission from Goyal G, et al. Blood 2022;139:2601-2621.
[u] For LCH without radiographic abnormalities (eg, skin, gastrointestinal [GI] tract), clinical criteria (physical exam, endoscopy) should be used to assess response.
[v] Patients with endocrinopathies from pituitary involvement may require ongoing hormone replacement despite attaining a radiographic complete response. Patients with single-system pulmonary LCH and abnormal PFTs at baseline should undergo follow-up testing to assess response.

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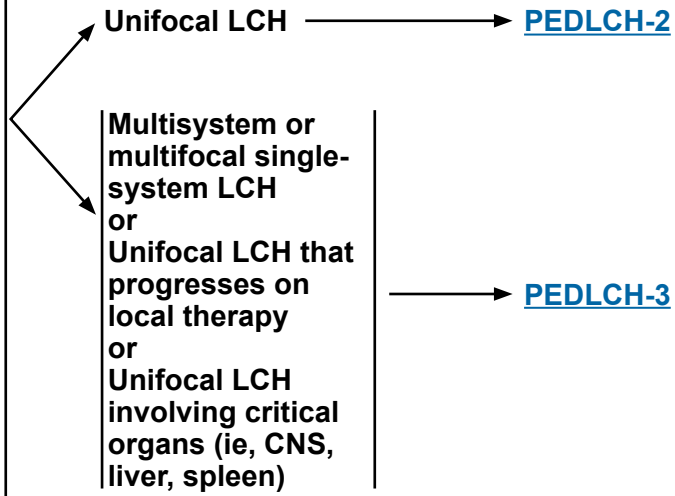
## WORKUP / EVALUATION[a,b]

**ESSENTIAL:**

- H&P[c] with attention to common sites of involvement[d]
- Skeletal radiographic survey to detect skeletal lesions
- Laboratory evaluation[c]:
  - If unexplained cytopenia or anemia, consider bone marrow biopsy to assess for involvement with LCH, hemophagocytic lymphohistiocytosis, or other concurrent myeloid neoplasms
- Tissue biopsy[e] (PEDLCH-1A)

**USEFUL UNDER CERTAIN CIRCUMSTANCES, BASED ON SYMPTOMS OR ORGAN INVOLVEMENT:**

- Whole-body FDG-PET/CT or FDG-PET/MRI (vertex to toes) can be used if available, if a concern is present for multisystem LCH (MS-LCH) with risk organ involvement, or if disease reactivation is suspected
- Contrast-enhanced CT/MRI for assessment of other organ system involvement
  - Low-dose CT (LDCT) of the chest for suspected pulmonary and thymus LCH
  - US for suspected liver/spleen LCH
  - US for suspected lymph node involvement based on abnormal physical examination findings
- Contrast-enhanced brain MRI (white matter, pituitary, and sella turcica) in patients with a new onset isolated AVP deficiency[f]; CNS-risk bone lesions (mastoid and temporal bones; bones forming orbit); and MS-LCH with high-risk organ involvement to rule out pituitary gland involvement and neurodegenerative CNS LCH
  - MRI of the spine is optional and should be conducted if neurological symptoms are present or other imaging shows vertebral bone lesion
- Refer to other subspecialties (based on the clinical pattern): dental, dermatology, endocrinology, ear, nose, and throat (ENT), neurology, neuropsychology, neurosurgery, ophthalmology, orthopedics, psychosocial support, rehabilitation services
- If necessary for diagnosis confirmation, other testing may include: PFTs, echocardiogram, ERCP, electrical auditory brainstem response (E-ABR)




[a] Refer to the NCCN Distress Thermometer and Problem List, which includes social determinants of health. See NCCN Guidelines for Distress Management (DIS-A).
[b] NCCN Guidelines for Adolescent and Young Adult (AYA) Oncology.
[c] Principles of Diagnostic Evaluation (HIST-A).
[d] Common sites of involvement include: bone, bone marrow, skin, GI system, lymph node, liver, spleen, oral mucosa, lung, and CNS. See Characteristic Features of Histiocytic Neoplasms (HIST-B).
[e] Principles of Pathology (HIST-C).
[f] Previously known as diabetes insipidus.

**Note: All recommendations are category 2A unless otherwise indicated.**

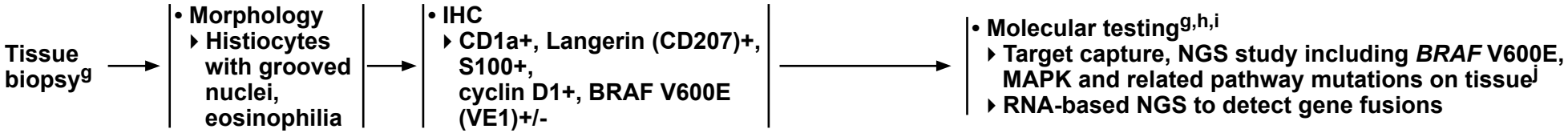


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## TISSUE BIOPSY ANALYSIS FOR LCH




Immunophenotype key: +/-: positive or negative; +: positive; -: negative

[g] For patients with suspected LCH or histiocytosis and biopsy is not possible because of location or risk factors, mutational analysis of the peripheral blood is an option.
[h] Molecular testing for somatic mutations and fusions can be performed in a stepwise manner or in parallel, depending on clinical need and institutional protocols. The frequency of suspected molecular lesions should drive the order of testing if a stepwise algorithm is chosen. Allele-specific PCR for *BRAF* V600E mutations can be the first step if BRAF V600E (VE1) IHC is not available or is equivocal. Targeted NGS panel testing should cover the common somatic mutations involving the MAPK pathway (ie, *BRAF*, *ARAF*, *NRAS*, *KRAS*, *MAP2K1/2*) and other related pathway mutations (eg, *PIK3CA*, *CSF1R*). RNA-based molecular panel including fusion testing should cover *BRAF*, *ALK*, *RET,* and *NTRK1* rearrangements. If ALK IHC is positive, the presence of a rearrangement should be confirmed molecularly (eg, by FISH or RNA sequencing).
[i] Principles of Molecular Testing (HIST-H).
[j] Fresh or paraffin-embedded tissue is used for NGS study; peripheral blood may be informative in multisystem disease.

**Note: All recommendations are category 2A unless otherwise indicated.**



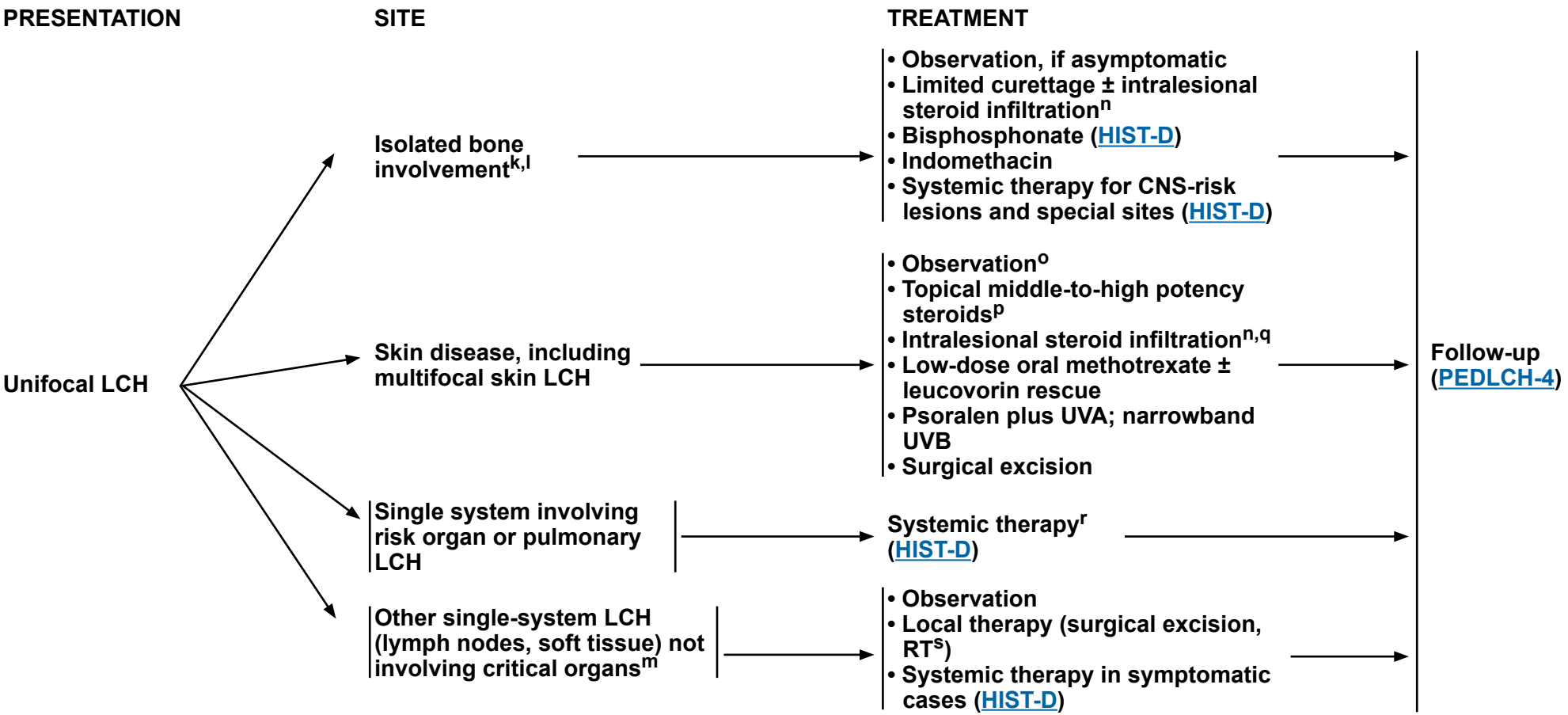
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# NCCN Guidelines Version 2.2026
# Pediatric Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis

NCCN Guidelines Index
Table of Contents
Discussion




[k] For single site bone lesions with symptomatic extra-skeletal component, RT or systemic therapy may be warranted.
[l] Sentinel lymph node changes (enlargement, hypermetabolic activity on FDG-PET imaging) should not be regarded as another system involved, unless histologically confirmed by lymph node biopsy (CD1a+ histiocytes, characteristic immuno-architecture).
[m] Liver, spleen, bone marrow, CNS, primary GI tract.
[n] Triamcinolone injection or equivalent corticosteroid.
[o] For small areas with no inflammatory changes.
[p] For larger areas or for lesions with inflammatory changes.
[q] For nodular lesions.
[r] Provide resources for cessation of smoking (see NCCN Guidelines for Smoking Cessation) and cannabis use (Fabozzi A, et al. BMC Pulm Med 2025;25:44), if applicable.
[s] Principles of Radiation Therapy (HIST-G).

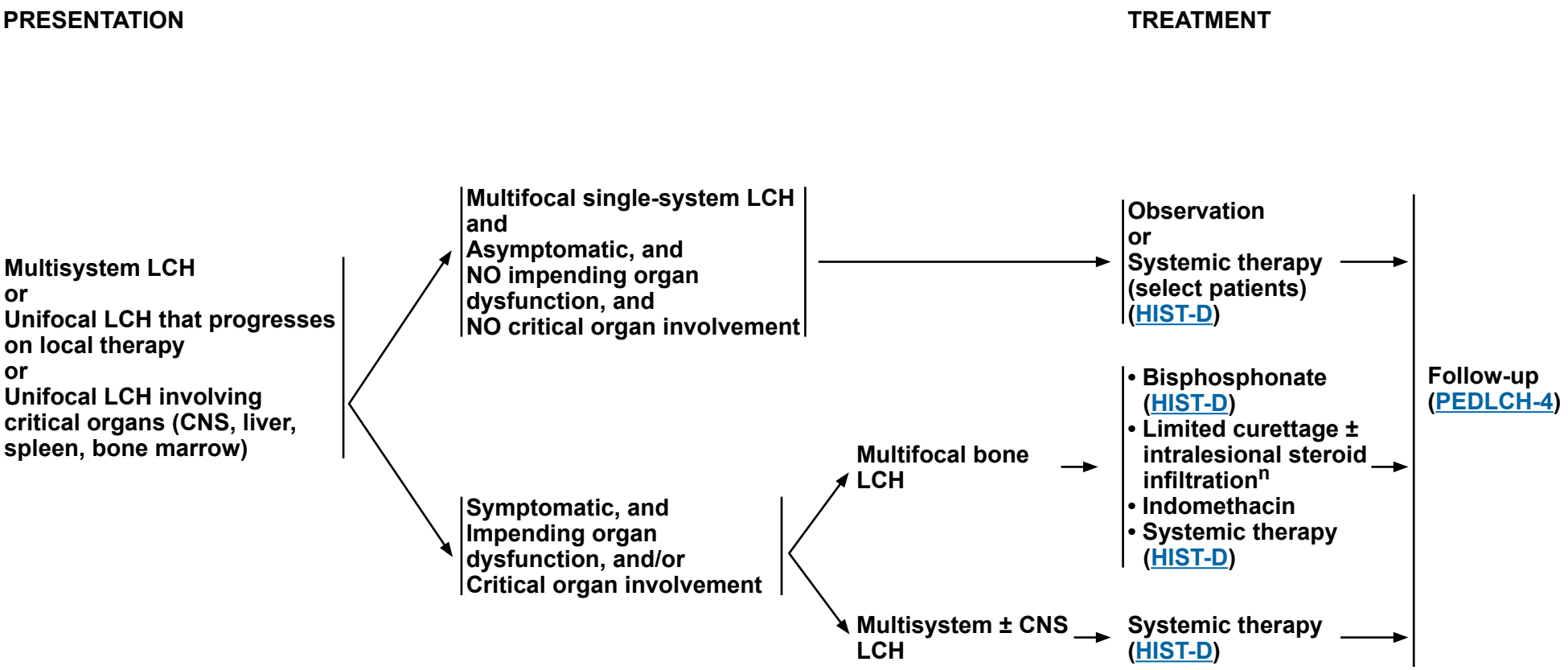
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[n] Triamcinolone injection or equivalent corticosteroid.

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## FOLLOW-UP[t]

**Treatment response assessment**

**Imaging of involved sites**

- Contrast-enhanced CT/MRI or consider skeletal radiographic survey to detect skeletal lesions or US for liver
  - After 2–3 cycles of systemic therapy and at completion
  - Immediately after completion of surgical curettage, and every 3 months until full evidence of the healed bone
  - After RT[s]

**Surveillance of patients on observation or in remission**

- H&P and labs at least annually or more frequently as clinically indicated (hormonal status, pituitary gland, and adrenal gland function)
- Imaging: contrast-enhanced CT/MRI or skeletal radiographic survey for reactivation
  - No more than every 6 months for up to 2 years post completion of treatment in the absence of a clinical concern of recurrence
  - >2 years: no more than annually
  - For patients who are asymptomatic with a single-site bone lesion, imaging surveillance can potentially end after year 1, with continued tracking of symptoms
- Annual brain MRI with and without contrast for patients with CNS-risk and high-risk lesions for 5 years and as clinically indicated thereafter
- Monitor PFTs every 6–12 months for up to 2 years for pulmonary LCH with further follow-up as clinically indicated
- Bone marrow evaluation for patients with prior bone marrow involvement or in the presence of unexplained CBC abnormality (to rule out associated myeloid neoplasm)
  - In the rare case of bone marrow involvement, repeat biopsy post-therapy to ensure it has been resolved
- For patients with:
  - BRAF inhibitors, regular skin examination, and echocardiogram[u]
  - MEK inhibitors, regular skin examination, retinal examination, and echocardiogram[u]
- Monitor every 1–2 years for pituitary hormone abnormalities
- Continue subspecialty involvement as indicated

## TREATMENT FOR RELAPSED/ REFRACTORY DISEASE

→ Systemic therapy (HIST-D)
- If duration of response >1 year, consider same regimen; otherwise use a regimen not used for first-line or consider a re-biopsy

→ See NCCN Guidelines for Survivorship

[s] Principles of Radiation Therapy (HIST-G).
[t] Principles of Supportive Care (HIST-E).
[u] Principles of Targeted Therapy (HIST-F).

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## WORKUP / EVALUATION[a,b]

**ESSENTIAL:**
- H&P[c] with attention to common sites of involvement[d]
- Whole-body FDG-PET/CT scan including distal extremities (vertex to toes)
- Laboratory evaluation[c]
  - If unexplained CBC abnormality, consider bone marrow biopsy to assess for hemophagocytic lymphohistiocytosis, ECD, and/or associated myeloid neoplasm[e]
- Tissue biopsy[f] (ECD-1A)
- MRI of the brain with and without contrast

**USEFUL UNDER CERTAIN CIRCUMSTANCES, BASED ON SYMPTOMS OR ORGAN INVOLVEMENT:**
- CT of the following:
  - chest, abdomen, and pelvis with contrast[g]
  - sinuses with contrast
  - chest (high-resolution)
- MRI with and without contrast for the following:
  - orbit
  - spine
  - sella turcica ± pituitary (if AVP deficiency[h] suspected)
- PFTs (especially for suspected pulmonary Erdheim-Chester disease [ECD])
- TTE
- Renal artery US
- Testicular US
- Technetium-99m (99mTc) methylene diphosphonate (MDP) bone scintigraphy

→ Treatment (ECD-2)

[a] Refer to the NCCN Distress Thermometer and Problem List, which includes social determinants of health. See NCCN Guidelines for Distress Management (DIS-A).
[b] Adapted with permission from Goyal G, et al. Blood 2020;135:1929-1945.
[c] See Principles of Diagnostic Evaluation (HIST-A) for details on H&P and laboratory evaluation.
[d] Common sites of involvement include: long bones (bilateral and symmetric diaphyseal and metaphyseal osteosclerosis with subchondral sparing); orbits (retro-orbital mass with exophthalmos; xanthelasma); CNS (pituitary gland, posterior fossa); lungs (interstitial changes); vascular (periaortic infiltrate; pericardium; right atrium); and retroperitoneal/perinephric or "hairy kidney" (mesentery). See Characteristic Features of Histiocytic Neoplasms (HIST-B).
[e] See NCCN Guidelines for Myelodysplastic Syndromes or NCCN Guidelines for Myeloproliferative Neoplasms.
[f] Principles of Pathology (HIST-C).
[g] The presence of hairy kidney is highly suggestive of ECD and is present in 50% to 68% of patients. Periarterial infiltration involving the thoracic or abdominal aorta and other vessels is present in 56% to 85% of patients with ECD. Goyal G, et al. Mayo Clin Proc 2019;94:2054-2071.
[h] Previously known as diabetes insipidus.

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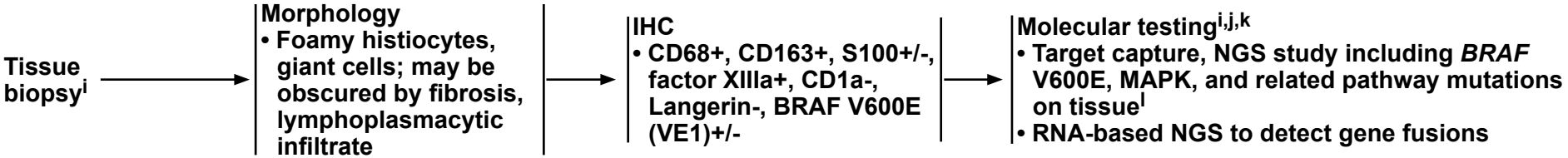
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# NCCN Guidelines Version 2.2026
# Erdheim-Chester Disease

NCCN Guidelines Index
Table of Contents
Discussion

## TISSUE BIOPSY ANALYSIS FOR ECD




Immunophenotype key: +/-: positive or negative; +: positive; -: negative

[i] For patients with suspected ECD or histiocytosis and biopsy is not possible because of location or risk factors, mutational analysis of the peripheral blood is an option. Janku F, et al. Mol Cancer Ther 2019;18:1149-1157.

[j] Molecular testing for somatic mutations and fusions can be performed in a stepwise manner or in parallel, depending on clinical need and institutional protocols. The frequency of suspected molecular lesions should drive the order of testing if a stepwise algorithm is chosen. Allele-specific PCR for *BRAF* V600E mutations can be the first step if BRAF V600E (VE1) IHC is not available or is equivocal. Targeted NGS panel testing should cover the common somatic mutations involving the MAPK pathway (ie, *BRAF*, *ARAF*, *NRAS*, *KRAS*, *MAP2K1/2*) and other related pathway mutations (eg, *PIK3CA*, *CSF1R*). RNA-based molecular panel including fusion testing should cover *BRAF*, *ALK*, *RET,* and *NTRK1* rearrangements. If ALK IHC is positive, the presence of a rearrangement should be confirmed molecularly (eg, by FISH or RNA sequencing).

[k] Principles of Molecular Testing (HIST-H).

[l] Fresh or paraffin-embedded tissue is used for the NGS study; peripheral blood testing may be informative in multisystem disease. If clinically indicated in cases without the usual MAPK pathway mutations, FISH for *BRAF*, *ALK*, *RET,* or *NTRK1* fusions may be performed.

**Note: All recommendations are category 2A unless otherwise indicated.**



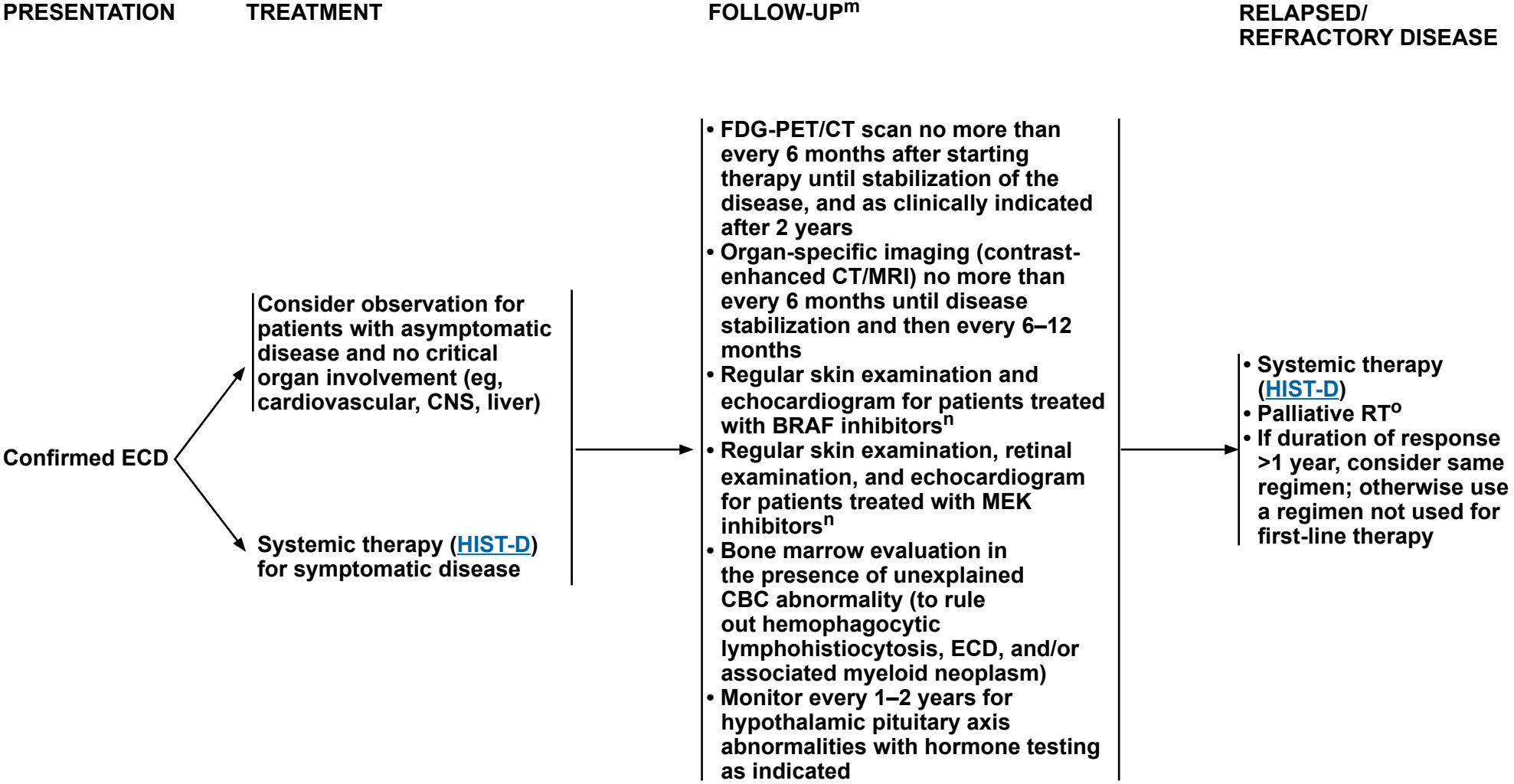
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# NCCN Guidelines Version 2.2026
# Erdheim-Chester Disease

NCCN Guidelines Index
Table of Contents
Discussion




[m] Principles of Supportive Care (HIST-E).
[n] Principles of Targeted Therapy (HIST-F).
[o] Principles of Radiation Therapy (HIST-G).

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# NCCN Guidelines Version 2.2026
# Rosai-Dorfman Disease

NCCN Guidelines Index
Table of Contents
Discussion

## WORKUP / EVALUATION[a,b]

**ESSENTIAL:**
- H&P[c] with attention to common sites of involvement[d]
- Whole-body FDG-PET/CT scan including distal extremities (vertex to toes)
- Laboratory evaluation[c]
- Tissue biopsy[e] (RDD-1A)
- MRI of the brain with and without contrast

**USEFUL UNDER CERTAIN CIRCUMSTANCES, BASED ON SYMPTOMS OR ORGAN INVOLVEMENT:**
- CT of the following:
  - chest, abdomen, and pelvis with contrast
  - sinuses with contrast
  - chest (high-resolution)
- MRI with and without contrast for the following:
  - orbit
  - spine
  - sella turcica ± pituitary (if AVP deficiency[f] suspected)
- PFTs (especially for suspected pulmonary Rosai-Dorfman disease [RDD])
- TTE
- Thyroid US
- Testicular US

→ Treatment (RDD-2)

[a] Refer to the NCCN Distress Thermometer and Problem List, which includes social determinants of health. See NCCN Guidelines for Distress Management (DIS-A).
[b] Adapted with permission from Abla O, et al. Blood 2018;131:2877-2890.
[c] See Principles of Diagnostic Evaluation (HIST-A) for details on H&P and laboratory evaluation.
[d] Common sites of involvement include: peripheral lymphadenopathy, subcutaneous nodules, and extranodal sites (ie, skin, soft tissue, upper respiratory tract, bone, retroperitoneum, orbits, spleen). See Characteristic Features of Histiocytic Neoplasms (HIST-B).
[e] Principles of Pathology (HIST-C).
[f] Previously known as diabetes insipidus.

**Note: All recommendations are category 2A unless otherwise indicated.**

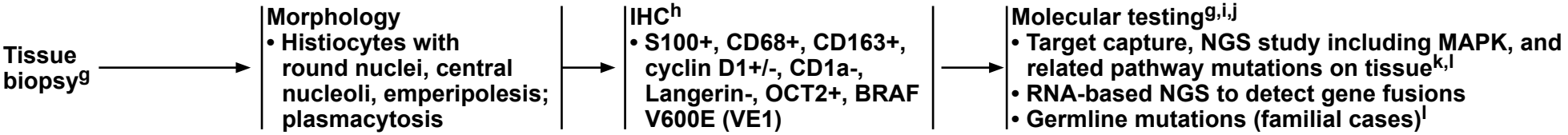


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## TISSUE BIOPSY ANALYSIS FOR RDD




Immunophenotype key: +/-: positive or negative; +: positive; -: negative

[g] For patients with suspected RDD or histiocytosis and biopsy is not possible because of location or risk factors, liquid biopsy for mutational analysis in the peripheral blood is an option. Janku F, et al. Mol Cancer Ther 2019;18:1149-1157.

[h] Of caution, cyclin D1 could also be positive or detected in concurrent lymphocytic or histiocytic neoplasm. VE1 is the preferred antibody for *BRAF* V600E testing if possible. A novel study showed that OCT2 IHC might be helpful, if clinically indicated, in select cases to confirm a suspected diagnosis of RDD, together with other common diagnostic markers. Ravindran A, et al. Am J Surg Pathol 2021;45:35-44.

[i] Molecular testing for somatic mutations and fusions can be performed in a stepwise manner or in parallel, depending on clinical need and institutional protocols. The frequency of suspected molecular lesions should drive the order of testing if a stepwise algorithm is chosen. Allele-specific PCR for *BRAF* V600E mutations can be the first step if BRAF V600E (VE1) IHC is not available or is equivocal. Targeted NGS panel testing should cover the common somatic mutations involving the MAPK pathway (ie, *BRAF*, *ARAF*, *NRAS*, *KRAS*, *MAP2K1/2*) and other related pathway mutations (eg, *PIK3CA*, *CSF1R*). RNA-based molecular panel including fusion testing should cover *BRAF*, *ALK*, *RET*, and *NTRK1* rearrangements. If ALK IHC is positive, the presence of a rearrangement should be confirmed molecularly (eg, by FISH or RNA sequencing).

[j] Principles of Molecular Testing (HIST-H).

[k] Fresh or paraffin-embedded tissue is used for the NGS study; peripheral blood testing may be informative in multisystem disease. If clinically indicated in cases without the usual MAPK pathway mutations, FISH for *BRAF*, *ALK*, *RET*, or *NTRK1* fusions may be performed.

[l] If a familial RDD is suspected, germline mutations in *SLC29A3* should be considered. Another germline gene mutation involving the *Fas* gene *TNFRSF6* is found in 40% of patients with RDD who had an autoimmune lymphoproliferative syndrome (ALPS) type Ia.

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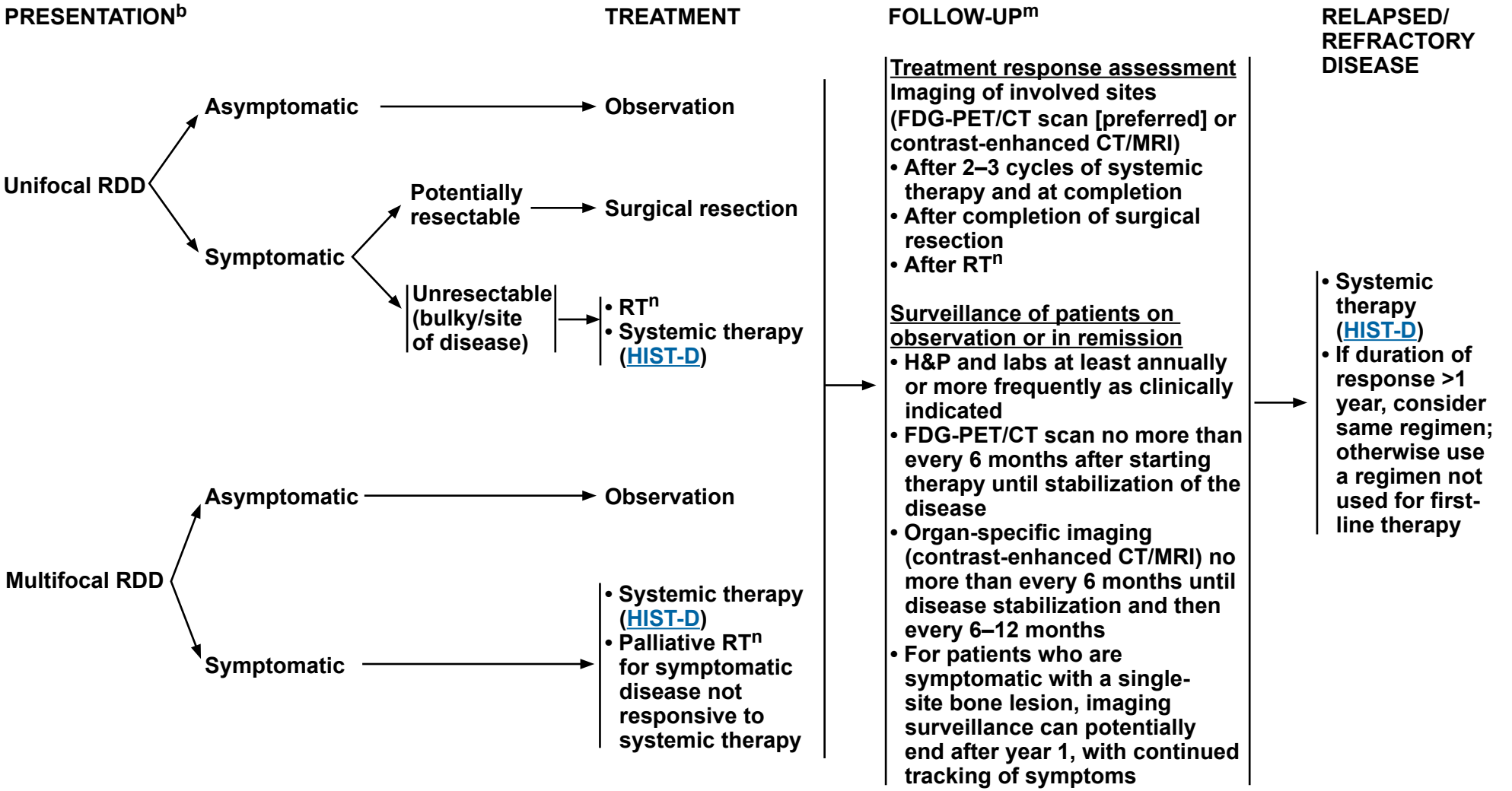
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# NCCN Guidelines Version 2.2026
# Rosai-Dorfman Disease

NCCN Guidelines Index
Table of Contents
Discussion




[b] Adapted with permission from Abla O, et al. Blood 2018;131:2877-2890.
[m] Principles of Supportive Care (HIST-E).
[n] Principles of Radiation Therapy (HIST-G).

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## WORKUP / EVALUATION[a]

**Includes: histiocytic sarcoma, Langerhans cell sarcoma, and interdigitating dendritic cell sarcoma**
- **Primary malignant histiocytic neoplasm (MHN) and secondary MHN[b]**
  - **Primary MHN refers to de novo disease without prior or concomitant hematologic malignancy while secondary MHN refers to prior or concomitant hematologic malignancy**

**ESSENTIAL:**
- **H&P[c] with attention to common sites of involvement[d]**
- **Whole-body FDG-PET/CT scan including distal extremities (vertex to toes)**
- **Laboratory evaluation[c]**
- **Tissue biopsy[e,f] (MHN-1A)**

**USEFUL UNDER CERTAIN CIRCUMSTANCES, BASED ON SYMPTOMS OR ORGAN INVOLVEMENT:**
- **CT of the chest, abdomen, and pelvis with contrast if additional structural details are needed**
- **Brain MRI with and without contrast**
- **Consider bone marrow biopsy for children, adults with unexplained CBC abnormalities, or marrow uptake on FDG-PET/CT to assess for MHN involvement, lymphoma, or other concomitant hematolymphoid neoplasm[f,g]**
- **Refer to RT[h] or palliative care[i] based on symptoms**
- **Refer to reproductive endocrinology (see NCCN Guidelines for Adolescent and Young Adult [AYA] Oncology)**
- **Refer to psychosocial supportive services upon diagnosis**

→ **Treatment (MHN-2)**

[a] Refer to the NCCN Distress Thermometer and Problem List, which includes social determinants of health. See NCCN Guidelines for Distress Management (DIS-A).
[b] A subset of MHN are clonally related to other hematolymphoid neoplasms (“secondary MHN”) and may present after, concurrently with, or, rarely, before diagnosis of the clonally related hematolymphoid neoplasm. The majority of clonally related hematolymphoid neoplasms recorded to date are lymphomas, predominantly mature B cell lymphomas, but also mature T and B lymphoblastic leukemias/lymphoma.
[c] Principles of Diagnostic Evaluation (HIST-A).
[d] Common sites of involvement include: lymph nodes, bone, liver, spleen, bone marrow, CNS, lung, and skin.
[e] Pathology should be sent to a center of excellence for confirmation of diagnosis due to the rarity of the disease.
[f] Principles of Pathology (HIST-C).
[g] See NCCN Guidelines for different lymphoma subtypes.
[h] Principles of Radiation Therapy (HIST-G).
[i] NCCN Guidelines for Palliative Care.

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## TISSUE BIOPSY ANALYSIS FOR MALIGNANT HISTIOCYTIC NEOPLASMS

**Tissue biopsy[j,k]** →

**Morphology**
- Pleomorphic, epithelioid to spindled
- If lymphoid infiltrate also present, rule out concomitant lymphoma (see NCCN Guidelines for Acute Lymphoblastic Leukemia and B-Cell Lymphomas)

→

**Immunohistochemistry[l,m]**
- Histiocytic sarcoma
  - Positive: at least 2 histiocytic markers (eg, CD163, CD68, lysozyme) AND negative for CD1a, Langerin
- Langerhans cell sarcoma
  - Positive: S100, CD1a, Langerin
- Interdigitating dendritic cell sarcoma
  - Positive: S100, hematolymphoid lineage (eg, CD45, CD43) and negative for histiocytic markers, Langerhans cell markers
- Consider PD-L1 expression testing for treatment guidance[n]

**Histopathologic features overlap with other poorly differentiated malignancies (pleomorphic, epithelioid to spindled cells); exclude as indicated:**
- Myeloid sarcoma/acute myeloid leukemia (MS/AML)[m]
  - CD34, CD117, MPO
- Malignant melanoma
  - SOX-10, MelanA (MART1), HMB45
  - Especially for S100+ diagnoses
- Follicular dendritic cell sarcoma
  - Positive: CD21, CD23, and/or CD35
- Carcinoma
  - Pankeratins
- Large cell or anaplastic lymphomas
  - CD30, B/T lineage markers
- ALK+ neoplasms
  - ALK

→

**Molecular testing[o,p]**
- Target capture, NGS study including MAPK and related pathway mutations
- RNA based NGS to detect gene fusions

[j] Biopsy of additional sites may be needed if clinical suspicion of secondary concomitant malignancy.
[k] Surgical biopsy (preferred) or multiple cores in separate cassettes if surgical biopsy is not feasible.
[l] PU.1 can be used as part of a panel to support histiocytic lineage, but it is less specific than CD163 and CD68 and is also expressed by lymphomas.
[m] At minimum, the IHC panel should include CD163, CD1a, Langerin, S100, +/- CD68, +/- CD4. MS/AML often show monocytic differentiation and may be negative for CD34, CD117, and MPO; consider AML-appropriate molecular testing and bone marrow biopsy (see NCCN Guidelines for Acute Myeloid Leukemia).
[n] Ravindran A, et al. Leuk Lymphoma 2025;66:2675-2684.
[o] Lymphoma-associated MHNs may also carry lymphoma-associated rearrangements such as *IGH::BCL2* and clonal immunoglobulin gene rearrangements.
[p] Principles of Molecular Testing (HIST-H).

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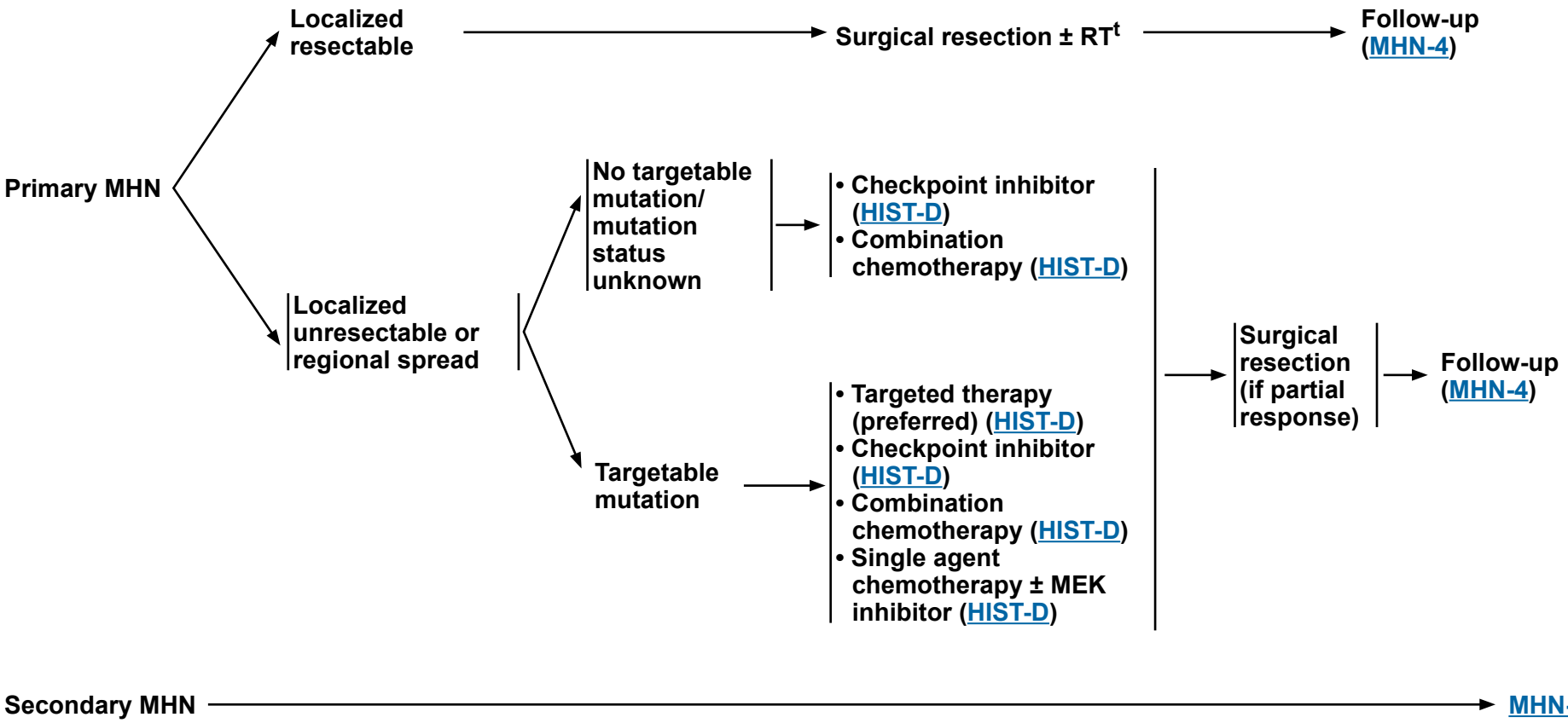
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# NCCN Guidelines Version 2.2026
# Malignant Histiocytic Neoplasms

NCCN Guidelines Index
Table of Contents
Discussion

**PRESENTATION** | **TREATMENT[q,r,s]**




[q] The role of autologous or allogeneic HSCT is uncertain. Consider consultation for HSCT in selected patients if a response was observed after systemic chemotherapy use.
[r] Limited data exists to determine the best therapy; therefore, the Panel recommends best clinical judgment be used in selecting an option.
[s] Equivalent options are listed in alphabetical order (HIST-D).
[t] Adjuvant radiation is encouraged as clinically indicated, especially in scenarios of incomplete resection or positive margins. It should be noted that higher doses will need to be given than with LCH. See Principles of Radiation Therapy (HIST-G).

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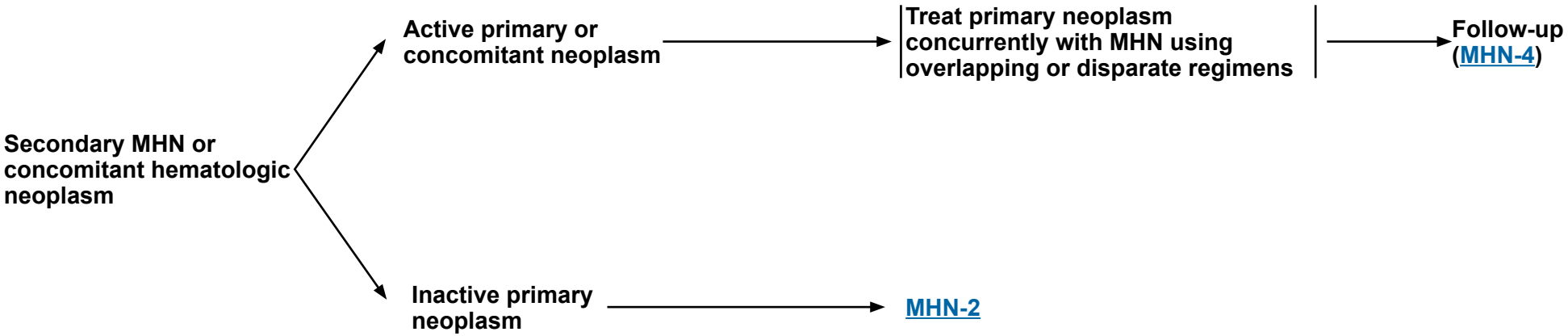
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**PRESENTATION**

**TREATMENT[q,r]**




[q] The role of autologous or allogeneic hematopoietic cell transplant (HCT) is uncertain. Consider consultation for HCT in selected patients if a response was observed after systemic chemotherapy use.
[r] Limited data exists to determine the best therapy; therefore, the Panel recommends best clinical judgment be used in selecting an option.

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## FOLLOW-UP[u]

**Treatment Assessment (for those currently on treatment)**

- Imaging (FDG-PET/CT or MRI of specific sites such as the brain) after 6–8 weeks of initiating treatment or if worsening clinical features
  - If response, subsequent imaging can be done in 3 months followed by every 3–6 months until 2 years

**Surveillance After Treatment**

- Imaging for up to 2 years
  - Whole-body FDG-PET/CT (FDG-PET/MRI if available) every 3–6 months
  - Organ-specific imaging (contrast-enhanced CT or MRI every 3–6 months)
- Observe for second malignancies
- Supportive care (pain or other symptom management)
  - See NCCN Guidelines for Supportive Care:
    - ◊ Adult Cancer Pain
    - ◊ Palliative Care
    - ◊ Cancer-Related Fatigue
    - ◊ Distress Management
    - ◊ Survivorship
- If recurrence, re-biopsy and NGS is recommended

## TREATMENT FOR RELAPSED/ REFRACTORY DISEASE

Alternative regimen type not previously used (see Systemic therapy [HIST-D])
or
Palliative RT[h]

[h] Principles of Radiation Therapy (HIST-G).
[u] Principles of Supportive Care (HIST-E).

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## PRINCIPLES OF DIAGNOSTIC EVALUATION

### Key Features of LCH[a]

| Sites | Frequency | Clinical and Radiologic Features |
|---|---|---|
| Bones | • 60% | • Osteolytic lesions, often involving skull |
| Dermatologic | • 15%-30% | • Papular rash, rarely subcutaneous nodules or xanthelasma-like lesions |
| Endocrine | • 50%-70% | • Most commonly AVP,[b] which often precedes diagnosis; hypothalamic and pituitary stalk lesions |
| Lymph nodes | • 5%-10% | • Rarely the only site of disease |
| Nervous system | • 5% | • Dural lesions, often extending from calvarium |
| Respiratory | • 50%-60% | • Often in smokers, upper lobe predominant nodules progressing to irregular cysts |

[a] Adapted with permission from Goyal G, et al. Mayo Clin Proc 2019;94:2054-2071.
[b] Previously known as diabetes insipidus.

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## PRINCIPLES OF DIAGNOSTIC EVALUATION

### Key Features of ECD[a]

| Sites | Frequency | Clinical and Radiologic Features |
|---|---|---|
| Arterial | • 50%-80% | • Periarterial infiltration involving aorta and other vessels |
| Bones | • 95% | • Osteosclerosis around knees pathognomonic |
| Cardiac | • 40%-70% | • Often involving right atrioventricular groove and right atrial wall |
| Dermatologic | • 25% | • Xanthelasma-like lesions |
| Endocrine | • 50%-70% | • Most commonly AVP,[b] which often precedes diagnosis; hypothalamic and pituitary stalk lesions |
| Nervous system | • 40% | • Dural, parenchymal, spinal cord, and nerve roots |
| Orbits | • 30% | • Orbital masses |
| Respiratory | • 50% | • Primarily pleural |
| Retroperitoneum | • 40%-50% | • Wispy infiltration in perinephric region ("hairy kidney") and adrenal infiltration |
| Testes | • 3%-5% | • May occur as hybrid/overlap disease with RDD |

[a] Adapted with permission from Goyal G, et al. Mayo Clin Proc 2019;94:2054-2071.
[b] Previously known as diabetes insipidus.

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## PRINCIPLES OF DIAGNOSTIC EVALUATION

### Key Features of RDD[a]

| Sites | Frequency | Clinical and Radiologic Features |
|---|---|---|
| Bones | • 15% | • Primarily osteolytic lesions |
| Dermatologic | • 50% | • Lobular soft tissue lesions in the subcutaneous space |
| Lymph nodes | • 30%-50% | • May manifest as isolated cervical or widespread lymphadenopathy |
| Nervous system | • 10% | • Dural and parenchymal lesions |
| Orbits | • 5% | • Orbital masses |
| Respiratory | • 10%-20% | • Primarily involving large airways and sinuses |
| Retroperitoneum | • 5%-10% | • Wispy infiltration and renal hilar masses |

### Associated Conditions of RDD

• Inherited: Familial RDD, ALPS type 1.
• Neoplasia associated: Hodgkin and non-Hodgkin lymphoma, concomitant ECD (overlap syndrome).
• Immune-related: Systemic lupus erythematosus (SLE), idiopathic juvenile arthritis, autoimmune hemolytic anemia.

[a] Adapted with permission from Goyal G, et al. Mayo Clin Proc 2019;94:2054-2071.

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## PRINCIPLES OF DIAGNOSTIC EVALUATION

**Laboratory Evaluation:**
- CBC with differential (ADULCH-1A or PEDLCH-1A or ECD-1A or RDD-1A)
- Comprehensive metabolic panel including liver and kidney function assessments
- For anemia: Coombs test, haptoglobin, reticulocyte count, and blood smear
- C-reactive protein (CRP)
- For LCH and ECD, endocrine panel including the following:
  - Morning urine and serum osmolality
  - Morning serum cortisol with adrenocorticotropic hormone (ACTH)
  - Follicle-stimulating hormone (FSH)/luteinizing hormone (LH) with testosterone (males) and estradiol (females)
  - Thyroid-stimulating hormone (TSH) and free T4[c]
  - Prolactin and insulin-like growth factor 1 (IGF-1)
- Lumbar puncture (for brain lesions inaccessible to biopsy)
- Bone marrow aspirate/biopsy in the presence of unexplained CBC abnormalities (ie, unexplained anemia or cytopenias) (ADULCH-1A or PEDLCH-1A or ECD-1A or RDD-1A)
- For RDD: Serum immunoglobulins
- For RDD: ALPS panel, antinuclear antibody (ANA), antineutrophil cytoplasmic antibodies (ANCA), rheumatoid factor (RF), HLA-B27: if autoimmune disease is suspected and based on clinical findings
- For pediatric LCH: Coagulation panel, plasma and urine osmolality, urinalysis/urine specific gravity

**Subspecialty Consultations as Needed:**
- Cardiology
- Pulmonary
- Neurology
- Endocrinology, especially for pediatric LCH to evaluate pituitary gland involvement
- Dermatology during BRAF or MEK inhibitor therapy[d]
- Ophthalmology during MEK inhibitor therapy[d]
- Dental/periodontal
- Smoking cessation[e]
- Palliative medicine[f]

[c] Makras P, et al. J Clin Endocrinol Metab 2025;110:1756-1766.
[d] Principles of Targeted Therapy (HIST-F).
[e] Provide resources for cessation of smoking (see NCCN Guidelines for Smoking Cessation) and cannabis use (Fabozzi A, et al. BMC Pulm Med 2025;25:44).
[f] NCCN Guidelines for Palliative Care.

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## CHARACTERISTIC FEATURES OF HISTIOCYTIC NEOPLASMS[a]

| Feature | ECD | LCH | RDD |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Bones** | Pathognomonic long-bone osteosclerosis at the metadiaphysis | Osteolytic lesions including skull | Cortex-based osteolytic lesions most common |
| **Nervous system** | Brainstem/cerebellum masses; cerebral white matter enhancement; dural and pituitary stalk thickening | MRI with globus pallidus/dentate nucleus T1 hyperintensity; brainstem/cerebellum T2 hyperintensity; dural lesion from intracranial extension of skull lesion; pituitary stalk thickening; disappearance of the posterior pituitary bright spot. | Isolated dural or parenchymal lesion |
| **Endocrine** | AVP deficiency[b] may present years before diagnosis of ECD | AVP deficiency[b] may present years before diagnosis of LCH | AVP deficiency[b] never reported |
| **Respiratory** | Mediastinal infiltration; pleural, septal, and maxillary sinus thickening | Mostly seen in people who smoke; HRCT shows pulmonary nodules in the early stage, cysts in the later stage | Primarily involving large airways and sinuses; rarely interstitial pulmonary or sinus thickening; pleural or pulmonary nodule |
| **Dermatologic** | Xanthelasma-like lesions around eyes, face, neck, inguinal folds | Papular rash; rarely subcutaneous nodules or xanthelasma-like lesions | Subcutaneous nodules, may be seen as macular or papular rash that varies in color |
| **Cardiac** | Right atrial and atrioventricular groove infiltration; pericardial and myocardial infiltration seen on cardiac MRI | Rarely reported | Infiltration of the right atrium, interatrial septum, and left ventricle |
| **Arterial** | Periaortic infiltration “coated aorta”; infiltration of the supra-aortic trunk branches, visceral arteries, renal artery stenosis, coronary arteries | Rarely reported | Infiltration of the periaortic and carotid sheath |

[a] Adapted with permission from Goyal G, et al. Mayo Clin Proc 2019;94:2054-2071.
[b] Previously known as diabetes insipidus.

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## CHARACTERISTIC FEATURES OF HISTIOCYTIC NEOPLASMS[a]

| Feature | ECD | LCH | RDD |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Retroperitoneum, including kidneys** | Perinephric infiltration “hairy kidneys” with extension to renal pelvis and ureters causing renal failure; adrenal infiltration | Rarely reported | Commonly hilar masses; subcapsular infiltration; rarely perinephric coating |
| **Lymph nodes** | Rarely reported | Rarely isolated | May present as isolated or generalized lymphadenopathy |
| **Orbits** | Orbital masses | Rarely reported | Orbital masses, sometimes involving the optic nerve |

[a] Adapted with permission from Goyal G, et al. Mayo Clin Proc 2019;94:2054-2071.

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## PRINCIPLES OF PATHOLOGY

**General Principles**

- LCH, ECD, and RDD pose a diagnostic challenge given their rarity, their overlap with each other, reactive processes, and co-occurrence with other hematologic or non-hematologic neoplasms.
- Numerous site-specific mimics of histiocytoses exist due to relatively nonspecific appearance and immunophenotype, such as granular cell tumor, giant cell tumors of the bone and soft tissue, xanthogranulomas, multicentric reticulohistiocytosis, and immunoglobulin G4 (IgG4)-related disease. Manifestations may also vary by site.[1,2]
- Comprehensive immunophenotyping should be performed including S100, CD1a, Langerin (CD207), CD68 and/or CD163, cyclin D1, BRAF V600E (VE1), factor XIIIa, and, if indicated, ALK and fascin. Discriminatory markers for carcinoma, melanoma, lymphoma, sarcoma, and other suspected disorders are useful for differential diagnoses. Cyclin D1 IHC can be helpful to distinguish LCH from reactive Langerhans cell collections and has also been reported to be positive in RDD.[3-5]
- It is recommended to perform molecular mutation profiling to aid in confirmation of a clonal Langerhans or histiocytic process and to identify potential prognostically relevant mutations or therapeutic targets. Correlation with clinical presentation and imaging findings is crucial for accurate diagnosis. Tissue diagnosis should be confirmed by pathologists with expertise in site-specific histiocytic lesions (eg, hematopathology, dermatopathology, pulmonary pathology, neuropathology).[6]
- In patients with unexplained cytopenias, bone marrow biopsy should be considered due to possible concomitant bone marrow processes, such as hemophagocytic lymphohistiocytosis or myeloid neoplasia (ie, myelodysplastic syndrome [MDS], myeloproliferative neoplasms [MPN], chronic myelomonocytic leukemia [CMML]).[7-12]
- For LCH and ECD, molecular testing for somatic mutations and fusions can be performed in a stepwise manner or in parallel, depending on clinical need and institutional protocols. The frequency of suspected molecular lesions should drive the order of testing if a stepwise algorithm is chosen. Allele-specific polymerase chain reaction (PCR) for BRAF V600E (VE1) mutations can be the first step if BRAF V600E (VE1) IHC is not available or is equivocal.[13] Somatic mutation NGS panel testing should cover the common MAPK pathway mutations. RNA-based molecular panel fusion testing should cover *BRAF*, *ALK*, *RET*, and *NTRK1* rearrangements. If ALK IHC is positive, the presence of a rearrangement should be confirmed molecularly (eg, by fluorescence in situ hybridization [FISH] or RNA sequencing).[14,15] Repeat molecular testing in negative cases, potentially using a different tissue sample.

**Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis**

- LCH is an abnormal proliferation of Langerhans-type cells with frequent driver mutations involving the MAPK pathway (RAS-RAF-MEK-ERK).
- Histopathologic features include cells with oval or twisted, grooved, or lobulated nuclei, finely granular chromatin, inconspicuous nucleoli, and abundant cytoplasm; these cells frequently have admixed eosinophils and histiocytes, including multinucleated forms, but not usually plasma cell rich. Ki-67 is variable.
- Reactive Langerhans cell infiltrates such as dermatopathic lymphadenopathy may mimic LCH.[16]
- Langerhans cells show immunoreactivity for S100, CD1a, Langerin (CD207) and cyclin D1 (BCL1) and, in *BRAF* V600E mutated cases, BRAF V600E (VE1 clone) supports LCH.[14] VE1 staining is not 100% sensitive or specific; to avoid false-positive results, unequivocal VE1 staining of 2+ intensity in ≥10% neoplastic histiocytes is required, and concurrent molecular testing is recommended.[17]
- Activating signaling pathway mutations found in LCH include *BRAF* V600E (approximately 50%), *BRAF* indels (32%), *MAP2K1/2*, *N/KRAS*, and *ARAF*. Kinase fusions (ie, *BRAF*, *ALK*, *RET*, *NTRK1*) and mutations in the PI3K-AKT-mTOR pathway have been reported in LCH as well.[18-20] Concomitant panel testing for BRAF V600E (VE1) and other MAPK pathway mutations is recommended.[21,22]
- Suspected bone marrow involvement should be assessed by immunohistochemistry with concurrent molecular testing recommended.
- Approximately 50% of pediatric LCH cases demonstrate a *BRAF* V600E mutation. In those with non-*BRAF* V600E-mutated LCH, NGS revealed the prevalence of other somatic mutations: *MAP2K1* exon 2 or 3 mutations (42%), *BRAF* exon 12 deletions and duplications (32%), other *BRAF* V600 codon mutation (4%), and non-MAPK pathway genes (4%).[23]

**Note: All recommendations are category 2A unless otherwise indicated.**

References on HIST-C 6 of 6



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## PRINCIPLES OF PATHOLOGY

**Erdheim-Chester Disease**

- Histopathologic features include foamy (xanthomatous) histiocytes, including Touton cells in a background of spindled cells and fibrosis. Reactive lymphocytes, plasma cells, and neutrophils are also often present. Typical histologic findings vary by site.[6] For example, bone lesions may be masked by significant fibrosis, including, in some cases, storiform fibrosis. In CNS and lung, the lesional histiocytes are non-lipidized, with eosinophilic cytoplasm, and lack the typical inflammatory infiltrate. In skin, the typical xanthomatous histiocytes are common but can be diffuse or interstitial and relatively subtle. In the retroperitoneum, findings are usually xanthomatous but sometimes extensively fibrotic. Finally, in cardiac tissues, diffuse infiltrates of xanthomatous histiocytes may be observed.
- The neoplastic cells show immunoreactivities for some histiocytic markers (eg, CD68, CD163, fascin, factor XIIIa). They are negative for CD1a and Langerin (CD207) and can be dim S100+.
- Activating signaling pathway mutations found in ECD are similar to those found in LCH, though *PIK3CA* activating mutation is more common in ECD. *BRAF* V600E mutation has been detected in about 50% of patients with ECD. Kinase fusions (ie, *BRAF*, *ALK*, *RET*, *NTRK1*) and *CSF1R* mutations have been reported rarely as well.[18,20,24]

**Rosai-Dorfman Disease**

- RDD comprises a heterogeneous group of clinical presentations that can be associated with familial, autoimmune, or malignant process. Classical sporadic RDD shows bilateral painless massive cervical lymphadenopathy associated with B symptoms. It is often also found in mediastinal, inguinal, and retroperitoneal lymph nodes. Extranodal RDD presentation is common.
- Hallmark histopathologic features of nodal RDD include dilated sinusoidal spaces filled with large histiocytes with a round to oval hypochromatic nucleus, an inconspicuous to distinct nucleolus, and abundant foamy to clear cytoplasm engulfing a variable number of intact inflammatory cells—namely emperipolesis, a phenomenon recognized in either physiologic or pathologic process. Large histiocytes are positive for monocyte-macrophage markers (ie, S100, CD68, CD163) and negative for LCH markers (ie, CD1a, Langerin [CD207]). Cyclin D1/BCL1 IHC can be helpful to confirm the diagnosis. There are often increased polyclonal plasma cells, and further study is needed for confirmation of IgG4 disorder.[25] Extranodal RDD shows more fibrosis and less frequent emperipolesis.[26]
- A subset of patients with RDD harbor gene mutations involving *NRAS*, *KRAS*, *MAP2K1/2*, and rarely *BRAF*.[24,27,28]
- Inherited conditions predisposing to RDD are typically seen in pediatric patients but could be considered in adolescents and young adults:
  - Another heterozygous germline gene mutation involving the *FAS* gene is *TNFRSF6*, which is found in 40% of patients with RDD who had an ALPS type Ia.
  - *SLC29A3* germline gene mutation leading to familial or Faisalabad histiocytosis and H syndrome (histiocytosis-lymphadenopathy plus syndrome).

**Malignant Histiocytic Neoplasms**

- Epithelioid to spindle-shaped cells with nuclear atypia
- Cytologically atypical nuclear features, abundant cytoplasm
- May have inflammatory background and/or admixed hematolymphoid neoplasm
- Localized or disseminated mass lesions involving lymph nodes, spleen, and a variety of extranodal sites
- Malignant histiocytic neoplasms pose a diagnostic challenge due to overlap with other more common aggressive malignancies ranging from acute myeloid leukemia to malignant melanoma, and are a diagnosis of exclusion. They may also co-present or sequentially present with clonally related hematolymphoid neoplasms, most commonly lymphomas.
- See Summary of Pathologic and Molecular Features of Histiocytic Neoplasms (HIST-C 5 of 6) for malignant histiocytic neoplasms.

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References on HIST-C 6 of 6



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## SUMMARY OF PATHOLOGIC AND MOLECULAR FEATURES OF HISTIOCYTIC NEOPLASMS[1]

| Disease | LCH | ECD | RDD |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Pathologic features** | | | |
| • Xanthomatous histiocytes | No | Yes | No |
| • Touton giant cells | No | Yes (mainly dermal sites) | No |
| • Emperipolesis | No | Rare | Abundant |
| **Cytologic features** | | | |
| • Nuclei | • Oval; retiform, irregular nuclear contours or grooves | • Bland; round-to-oval; small; no grooves | • Large round; hypochromatic |
| • Nucleoli | • Inconspicuous | • Inconspicuous | • Variable inconspicuous to distinct |
| • Cytoplasm | • Abundant; eosinophilic | • Classically abundant, amorphous lipid-laden or granular/xanthomatous but often overlap with JXG/AXG* | • Abundant foamy, clear without xanthomatous features; frequent emperipolesis |
| • Background cells | • Increased eosinophils, eosinophilic microabscesses | • Inflammatory cells including few small lymphocytes and plasma cells, rare eosinophils, and dense fibrosis | • Increased mature plasma cells, polyclonal, IgG4; occasional neutrophils |

* JXG: juvenile xanthogranuloma; AXG: adult xanthogranuloma.

[1] Adapted with permission from Goyal G, Heaney ML, Collin M, et al. Erdheim-Chester disease: consensus recommendations for evaluation, diagnosis, and treatment in the molecular era. Blood 2020;135:1929-1945.

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## SUMMARY OF PATHOLOGIC AND MOLECULAR FEATURES OF HISTIOCYTIC NEOPLASMS[1]

| Disease | LCH | ECD | RDD |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Molecular Features** | | | |
| • *BRAF* V600E (VE1) | 55% | 50% | 3% |
| • *MAP2K1* | 15% | 18% | 15% |
| • *RAS* isoforms (*KRAS*, *NRAS*) | 2% | 8% | 30% |
| • *BRAF* deletions | 6% | 2% | None |
| • PI3K isoforms (*PIK3CA*, *PIK3CD*) | 1% | 3% | None |
| • *ARAF* | 1% | 4% | 3% |
| • Other *BRAF* missense | 3% | None | None |
| • *RAF1* | None | 1% | None |
| • *MAP2K2* | None | 1% | None |
| • *MAP3K1* | Reported | (1 case) (Amplification) | None |
| • *CSF1R* | 1% | 1% | 1% |
| • *BRAF* fusions | 3% | 2% | None |
| • *ALK* fusions | None | 3% | None |
| • *NTRK1* fusions | None | 1% | None |
| • *RET* fusions | 1% | 1% | 1% |
| **Immunophenotype** | | | |
| • CD68 (cytoplasmic) | + (paranuclear cytoplasmic dot) | ++ | ++ |
| • CD163 (surface) | - | ++ | ++ |
| • CD14 (surface) | - | ++ | ++ |
| • CD1a (surface) | ++ | - | - |
| • Langerin (CD207) (cytoplasmic) | ++ | - | - |
| • Cyclin D1 | + | +/- | +/- |
| • S100 (cytoplasmic/nuclear) | + | +/- | + |
| • Factor XIIIa (cytoplasmic) | - | + | +/- |
| • Fascin (cytoplasmic) | - | + | + |
| • *BRAF* V600E (VE1) (cytoplasmic)[a] | +/-* | +/-* | - (Rare case reports++) |
| • *ALK* (cytoplasmic)[b] | - | +/-* | - |
| • *NTRK1* (cytoplasmic) | - | +/- | - |
| • OCT2 | - | - | + |

Immunophenotype key: ++, strongly positive; +, weakly positive; +/-, positive or negative; -, negative.
*Moderate to strong positivity should correlate with molecular alteration.

Footnotes
[a] Negative or equivocal IHC for BRAF V600E (VE1) does not exclude mutated *BRAF* V600E. Test with NGS panel to cover the common mutations, including *BRAF*, *MAP2K1/2*, *NRAS*, and *KRAS*.
[b] Testing *BRAF, ALK, RET, and NTRK1* fusions is recommended if clinically histiocytosis is suspected and NGS panel testing does not reveal *BRAF* or other MAPK pathway mutations. Testing for somatic mutations using NGS first or in parallel is recommended.

[1] Adapted with permission from Goyal G, Heaney ML, Collin M, et al. Erdheim-Chester disease: consensus recommendations for evaluation, diagnosis, and treatment in the molecular era. Blood 2020;135:1929-1945.

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## SUMMARY OF PATHOLOGIC AND MOLECULAR FEATURES OF HISTIOCYTIC NEOPLASMS[1,2,3]

| Disease | Malignant Histiocytic Neoplasms | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pathologic features | Epithelioid to spindle-shaped cells with nuclear atypia | | |
| Cytologic features | Cytologically atypical nuclear features, abundant cytoplasm | | |
| Background cells | May have inflammatory background and/or admixed hematolymphoid neoplasm | | |
| Molecular features | Same spectrum as non-malignant histiocytosis (eg, MAPK pathway mutations), with or without<br>Alterations seen across malignant entities (eg, *TP53*, *CDKN2A*), with or without<br>Shared clonal rearrangements/mutations of an associated hematolymphoid neoplasm (eg, *IGH::BCL2*) | | |
| Subtype | Histiocytic Sarcoma | Langerhans Cell Sarcoma | Interdigitating Dendritic Cell Sarcoma |
| Immunophenotype[c] | | | |
| • CD68 | + | + | + |
| • CD163 | + | + | -/+ |
| • Lysozyme | + | -/+ | + |
| • Oct2 | +/- | +/- | +/- |
| • CD1a | - | + | - |
| • Langerin (CD207) | - | + | - |
| • S100 | +/- | + | + |
| • Bcl1 (cyclin D1) | +/- | +/- | +/- |
| • BRAF V600E (VE1) | -/+ | -/+ | -/+ |
| • ALK | - | - | - |

Footnote

[c] Other entities in the differential, including but not limited to myeloid sarcoma/acute myeloid leukemia, malignant melanoma, carcinoma, follicular dendritic cell sarcoma, and large cell and anaplastic lymphoma, must be excluded as indicated. If a second atypical population is present, it should be assessed for a possible concurrent hematolymphoid neoplasm.

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## PRINCIPLES OF SYSTEMIC THERAPY[a,b]

### Adult Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis

**• Regimens may be used in the first- or subsequent-line setting.**

#### Multisystem or single-system pulmonary LCH

**Preferred**

- *BRAF* V600E-mutated disease
  - Vemurafenib[c,1,2]
- MAP kinase pathway mutation, or no other detectable/actionable mutation, or testing not available
  - Cobimetinib[c,3]
- Irrespective of mutation
  - Cytarabine[4,5]
  - Cladribine[6,7]

**Other Recommended**

- *BRAF* V600E-mutated disease
  - Dabrafenib[c,2,8]
- MAP kinase pathway mutation, or no other detectable/actionable mutation, or testing not available
  - Trametinib[c,8-12]
  - Binimetinib [c,d,8-12]
  - Selumetinib[c,d,8-12]
- Irrespective of mutation
  - Oral Methotrexate[13,14]
  - Hydroxyurea[15]
  - Clofarabine[16]
  - Vinblastine/Prednisone[4]
  - Cytarabine/Methotrexate[17]

**Useful in Certain Circumstances**

- Crizotinib for *ALK* fusion[18]
- Pexidartinib for *CSF1R* mutation[18]
- Larotrectinib for *NTRK1* gene fusion[19,20]
- Entrectinib for *NTRK1* gene fusion[19,21]
- Repotrectinib for *NTRK1* gene fusion[22]
- Sirolimus or Everolimus for *PIK3CA* mutation[23,24]
- Selpercatinib for *RET* fusion[18]
- Tovorafenib for *BRAF* alterations

**Relapsed/Refractory**

- Allogeneic HCT (for highly select patients)[25,26]

#### Bone disease only

**Preferred**

- Bisphosphonates
  - Zoledronic acid[27]
  - Pamidronate[27]

**Useful in Certain Circumstances**

- Multifocal single-system bone disease not responsive to Bisphosphonate
  - See preferred, other recommended, and useful in certain circumstances options above for multisystem disease

[a] Recommend starting targeted agents at lower dose. See Principles of Targeted Therapy (HIST-F).
[b] Some therapies have not been studied in histiocytic disease; thus, some data are being extrapolated from other disease sites.
[c] Principles of Targeted Therapy (HIST-F).
[d] If Cobimetinib or Trametinib are not tolerated.

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## PRINCIPLES OF SYSTEMIC THERAPY[a,b]

### Adult Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis

**• Regimens may be used in the first- or subsequent-line setting.**

| Single-system multifocal skin disease (including mucosa) | CNS disease | |
|---|---|---|
| **Preferred**<br>• Oral Methotrexate[13,14]<br>• Hydroxyurea[15]<br><br>**Other Recommended**<br>• Lenalidomide[28]<br>• Thalidomide[29] | **Preferred**<br>• *BRAF* V600E-mutated disease<br>▸ Vemurafenib[c,1,2]<br>• MAP kinase pathway mutation, or no other detectable/actionable mutation, or testing not available<br>▸ Cobimetinib[c,3]<br>• Irrespective of mutation<br>▸ Cytarabine[e,4]<br>▸ Cladribine[6,7]<br><br>**Other Recommended**<br>• *BRAF* V600E-mutated disease<br>▸ Dabrafenib[c,2,8]<br>• MAP kinase pathway mutation, or no other detectable/actionable mutation, or testing not available<br>▸ Trametinib[c,8-12]<br>▸ Binimetinib[c,d,8-12]<br>▸ Selumetinib[c,d,8-12]<br>• Irrespective of mutation<br>▸ High-dose Methotrexate[30]<br>▸ Cytarabine/Methotrexate[17] | **Useful in Certain Circumstances**<br>• Crizotinib for *ALK* fusion[18]<br>• Pexidartinib for *CSF1R* mutation[18]<br>• Larotrectinib for *NTRK1* gene fusion[19,20]<br>• Entrectinib for *NTRK1* gene fusion[19,21]<br>• Repotrectinib for *NTRK1* gene fusion[22]<br>• Sirolimus or Everolimus for *PIK3CA* mutation[23,24]<br>• Selpercatinib for *RET* fusion[18] |

[a] Recommend starting targeted agents at lower dose. See Principles of Targeted Therapy (HIST-F).
[b] Some therapies have not been studied in histiocytic disease; thus, some data are being extrapolated from other disease sites.
[c] Principles of Targeted Therapy (HIST-F).
[d] If Cobimetinib or Trametinib are not tolerated.
[e] Higher dose (150 mg/m$^2$) is indicated for CNS lesions.

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## PRINCIPLES OF SYSTEMIC THERAPY[a,b]

**Pediatric Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis**

**• Regimens may be used in the first- or subsequent-line setting**

| Multisystem or single-system pulmonary LCH | Bone disease only | CNS disease |
|---|---|---|
| **Preferred (irrespective of mutation)**<br>• Vinblastine/Prednisone ± 6-mercaptopurine[31]<br>• Cladribine[32]<br>• Cytarabine[33]<br>• Clofarabine[34,35]<br><br>**Other Recommended**<br>• *BRAF* V600E mutated disease<br>▸ Dabrafenib[c]<br>▸ Vemurafenib[c]<br>• MAP kinase pathway mutation, or no other detectable/actionable mutation, or testing not available<br>▸ Binimetinib[c]<br>▸ Cobimetinib[c]<br>▸ Selumetinib[c]<br>▸ Trametinib[c]<br><br>**Useful in Certain Circumstances**<br>• Other targeted agents may be considered for disease with other uncommon targetable mutations (see adult Langerhans cell histiocytosis regimens [HIST-D 1]) but may not be approved by the FDA | **Preferred**<br>• Bisphosphonate (zoledronic acid)[27]<br>• Indomethacin[36]<br>• Vinblastine/Prednisone ± 6-mercaptopurine[31] | **Preferred**<br>• LCH mass lesions[f]<br>▸ Vinblastine/Prednisone[31]<br>▸ Cytarabine<br>• LCH-associated abnormal CNS imaging/ Neurodegeneration (LACI/ND):<br>▸ Cytarabine ± IVIG[37]<br>▸ MAPKi (Vemurafenib, Dabrafenib [BRAF inhibitor]; Trametinib, Selumetinib [MAPK inhibitor]) with CNS penetration[c] |

[a] Recommend starting targeted agents at lower dose. See Principles of Targeted Therapy (HIST-F).
[b] Some therapies have not been studied in histiocytic disease, thus, some data are being extrapolated from other disease sites.
[c] Principles of Targeted Therapy (HIST-F).
[f] Hypothalamic-pituitary involvement; enlargement and enhancement of the pineal gland; thickening and enhancement of the choroid plexus; intraparenchymal masses.

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## PRINCIPLES OF SYSTEMIC THERAPY[a,b]

**Erdheim-Chester Disease**

**• Regimens may be used in the first- or subsequent-line setting.**

### Erdheim-Chester Disease

**Preferred**

- *BRAF* V600E-mutated disease
  - Vemurafenib[c,1,38]
- MAP kinase pathway mutation, or no other detectable/actionable mutation, or testing not available
  - Cobimetinib[c,39]

**Other Recommended**

- *BRAF* V600E-mutated disease
  - Dabrafenib[c,39,40]
- MAP kinase pathway mutation, or no other detectable/actionable mutation, or testing not available
  - Trametinib[c,10,41]
- Irrespective of mutation
  - Cladribine[42]
  - Pegylated interferon alpha-2a and alpha-2b[g,43]
  - Sirolimus/Prednisone[44]
  - Oral Methotrexate[45]
  - Anakinra[c,46,47]

**Useful in Certain Circumstances**

- Crizotinib for *ALK* fusion[18]
- Alectinib for *ALK* fusion[48]
- Brigatinib for *ALK* fusion[48]
- Ceritinib for *ALK* fusion[48]
- Lorlatinib for *ALK* fusion[48]
- Pexidartinib for *CSF1R* mutation[18,49]
- Larotrectinib for *NTRK1* gene fusion[19,20]
- Entrectinib for *NTRK1* gene fusion[19,21]
- Repotrectinib for *NTRK1* gene fusion[22]
- Sirolimus or Everolimus for *PIK3CA* mutation[23,24]
- Selpercatinib for *RET* fusion[18]

[a] Recommend starting targeted agents at lower dose. See Principles of Targeted Therapy (HIST-F).
[b] Some therapies have not been studied in histiocytic disease; thus, some data are being extrapolated from other disease sites.
[c] Principles of Targeted Therapy (HIST-F).
[g] Peginterferon alfa-2a is the only peginterferon alfa available for clinical use in the United States and it may be substituted for peginterferon alfa-2b (Schiller M, et al. J Eur Acad Dermatol Venerol 2017;31:1841-1847; Patsatsi A, et al. J Eur Acad Dermatol Venereol 2022;36:e291-e293; Osman S, et al. Dermatologic Therapy 2023;2023:7171937).

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## PRINCIPLES OF SYSTEMIC THERAPY[a,b]

### Rosai-Dorfman Disease

**• Regimens may be used in the first- or subsequent-line setting.**

| Rosai-Dorfman Disease |
|---|
| **Preferred** |
| • MAP kinase pathway mutation, or no other detectable/actionable mutation, or testing not available |
| ▸ Cobimetinib[c,50,51] |
| • Irrespective of mutation |
| ▸ Cladribine[52] |
| ▸ Cytarabine[53] |
| ▸ Lenalidomide ± Dexamethasone[54-57] |
| ▸ Oral Methotrexate[58,59] |
| ▸ Prednisone or other corticosteroid[52] |
| **Other Recommended** |
| • MAP kinase pathway mutation, or no other detectable/actionable mutation, or testing not available |
| ▸ Trametinib[c,10] |
| • Irrespective of mutation |
| ▸ Vinblastine/Prednisone[60] |
| ▸ Methotrexate (IV or SC)[61,62] |
| **Useful in Certain Circumstances** |
| • Crizotinib for *ALK* fusion[18] |
| • Pexidartinib for *CSF1R* mutation[18] |
| • Larotrectinib for *NTRK1* gene fusion[19,20] |
| • Entrectinib for *NTRK1* gene fusion[19,21] |
| • Repotrectinib for *NTRK1* gene fusion[22] |
| • Everolimus for *PIK3CA* mutation[23,24] |
| • Selpercatinib for *RET* fusion[18] |
| • Sirolimus (for those associated with ALPS and/or *PIK3CA* mutation)[23,24,63] |
| • Irrespective of mutation |
| ▸ Rituximab[h] (for IgG4-related, nodal and immune-cytopenia diseases)[64] |
| ▸ Thalidomide (for cutaneous involvement only)[65] |

[a] Recommend starting targeted agents at lower dose. See Principles of Targeted Therapy (HIST-F).
[b] Some therapies have not been studied in histiocytic disease; thus, some data are being extrapolated from other disease sites.
[c] Principles of Targeted Therapy (HIST-F).
[h] An FDA-approved biosimilar is an appropriate substitute for any recommended systemic biologic therapy in the NCCN Guidelines.

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## PRINCIPLES OF SYSTEMIC THERAPY[i]

**Malignant Histiocytic Neoplasms[j]**
- **Regimens may be used in the first- or subsequent-line setting**
- **Columns not in order of preference**

| Targeted Therapy | Immune Checkpoint Inhibitors (ICIs) | Combination Chemotherapy | Single Agent Chemotherapy ± MEK Inhibitor[85] | Immunomodulators (Relapsed/Refractory Disease Only) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ***BRAF* V600E mutated disease (without *RAS* mutation)**<br>• Vemurafenib[c,66,67]<br>• Dabrafenib[c,68-70]<br><br>**MAPK pathway mutation**<br>• Cobimetinib[c,71]<br>• Trametinib[c,68-70,72-74]<br><br>**Other alterations**<br>• *CSF1R* mutated disease<br>▸ Pexidartinib[18]<br>• *ALK* fusion positive disease<br>▸ Crizotinib[18]<br>• *NTRK1* fusion positive disease<br>▸ Larotrectinib[19,20]<br>▸ Entrectinib[19,21]<br>▸ Repotrectinib[22]<br>• *PIK3CA* mutated disease<br>▸ Sirolimus or Everolimus[23,24,75,76]<br>• *RET* fusion positive disease<br>▸ Selpercatinib[18] | • Pembrolizumab[k,77-81]<br>• Nivolumab[l,82-84] | • Lymphoma-type regimens (ICE, CHOP, ESHAP)[m,71]<br>• Leukemia-type regimens (those used in pediatrics) (see Relapsed/Refractory Disease in NCCN Guidelines for Acute Lymphoblastic Leukemia or NCCN Guidelines for Pediatric Acute Lymphoblastic Leukemia)<br>• Sarcoma-like (Doxorubicin/Ifosfamide/Mesna [AIM])[71] | • Cladribine<br>• Cytarabine<br>• Clofarabine (pediatrics only)<br>• Vinblastine<br>• Etoposide<br><br>**MEK inhibitors**<br>• Cobimetinib[c]<br>• Trametinib[c] | • Thalidomide or Lenalidomide[n,86-89]<br>• Alemtuzumab[90] |

[c] Principles of Targeted Therapy (HIST-F).
[i] Studies included only patients less than 18 years of age.
[j] Clinical trials are preferred.
[k] Pembrolizumab and berahyaluronidase alfa-pmph subcutaneous injection may be substituted for IV Pembrolizumab. Pembrolizumab and berahyaluronidase alfa-pmph has different dosing and administration instructions compared to IV Pembrolizumab.
[l] Nivolumab and hyaluronidase-nvhy subcutaneous injection may be substituted for IV Nivolumab. Nivolumab and hyaluronidase-nvhy has different dosing and administration instructions compared to IV Nivolumab.
[m] ICE (Ifosfamide/Carboplatin/Etoposide), CHOP (Cyclophosphamide/Doxorubicin/Vincristine/Prednisone), ESHAP (Etoposide/Methylprednisolone/Cytarabine/Cisplatin).
[n] Reproductive/fetal abnormalities should be considered when using these drugs. See Fertility, Reproductive, Endocrine, and Sexual Health Considerations in NCCN Guidelines for Adolescent and Young Adult (AYA) Oncology.

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## PRINCIPLES OF SUPPORTIVE CARE[1-4]

**Chronic Pain, Fatigue, Depression, Anxiety, and Poor Quality of Life**

- Patients with histiocytic disorders (especially ECD and LCH) often struggle with chronic generalized pain and fatigue that is out of proportion to the disease involvement.
- Many of these patients fit the criteria for myalgic encephalomyelitis/chronic fatigue syndrome.
- There is a high prevalence of depression and anxiety that compounds these symptoms further.
- In some instances, there is residual pain at the site of a tumor bed despite complete resection, especially in the case of bone lesions from LCH.
- Chronic pain may not respond well to available analgesic drugs.
- These symptoms can worsen the health-related quality of life of these patients significantly.
- It is important for clinicians to acknowledge these symptoms fully and refer the patients to appropriate specialties (eg, palliative medicine, psychiatry, psychology).
- In cases with severe fatigue, oral stimulants like methylphenidate can be used and appear to be safe for long-term use.
- Treatment of depression and anxiety with pharmacotherapy or psychotherapy may help with improvement of these symptoms.
- Continue follow-up with pulmonary/neurology/endocrinology specialist during surveillance.
- See NCCN Guidelines for Supportive Care:
  - Adult Cancer Pain
  - Cancer-Related Fatigue
  - Distress Management
  - Survivorship

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## PRINCIPLES OF TARGETED THERAPY[a]

**Toxicities of BRAF and MEK Inhibitors**

- Most patients are unable to tolerate full doses of BRAF and MEK inhibitors that are approved for melanoma. For patients without CNS involvement, it may be reasonable to start at half the approved dose and modify based on toxicities.
- Some patients may be able to tolerate chronic low-dose administration of BRAF and MEK inhibitors, especially after attainment of best response. Dose reductions and treatment breaks are highly individualized with close monitoring for relapse.
- ECG monitoring is recommended for patients on BRAF inhibitors as clinically indicated.
- Cardiomyopathy may occur with MEK inhibitors. Monitoring is recommended as clinically indicated.
- Hypersensitivity reaction may occur with administration. Monitor for and treat hypersensitivity reactions.
- Electrolytes (eg, magnesium, potassium) should be monitored prior to and 15 days after initiation of therapy, then monthly during the first 3 months and every 3 months thereafter or as clinically indicated.
- Liver function should be monitored prior to initiation of therapy, then monthly or as clinically indicated for potential dose modification or discontinuation.
- Renal function should be monitored prior to initiation of therapy and as clinically indicated for potential dose modification or discontinuation.
- Serious hemorrhagic events may occur with therapy. Evaluate risk of bleeding prior to initiation of therapy, then monitor for signs and symptoms of bleeding as clinically indicated.
- This agent may be associated with hemolytic anemia in patients with glucose-6-phosphate dehydrogenase (G6PD) deficiency. Patients should be monitored for signs and symptoms of hemolytic anemia, and screening for G6PD status may be warranted.
- Pyrexia (defined as a temperature of ≥38.3 °C) is a common (~55%) side effect of combining BRAF and MEK inhibitors and occurs less frequently with BRAF inhibitor monotherapy (~20%).[b] The pyrexia is episodic, with a median duration of 9 days, and onset is often 2 to 4 weeks following the start of therapy. Pyrexia may be associated with chills, night sweats, rash, dehydration, electrolyte abnormalities, and hypotension. Stopping or holding BRAF/MEK inhibitor combination at the onset of pyrexia will often interrupt the episode, and treatment can be resumed with full-dose BRAF/MEK inhibitors upon cessation of pyrexia and pyrexia-related symptoms. Upon re-exposure to BRAF/ MEK inhibitors, repeat pyrexia events can occur, but grade >3 events are uncommon (21%). In occasional instances of prolonged or severe pyrexia not responsive to discontinuation of BRAF/MEK inhibitors, low-dose corticosteroids (prednisone 10 mg/day) can be used. Patients with pyrexia should be advised to use antipyretics as needed and increase fluid intake.

[a] Refer to full prescribing information for individual agents regarding specific and additional information (https://www.accessdata.fda.gov/scripts/cder/daf).
[b] The frequency of pyrexia and other adverse events varies between specific BRAF/MEK inhibitor combinations.

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## PRINCIPLES OF TARGETED THERAPY[a]

**Toxicities of BRAF and MEK Inhibitors (continued)**

- Regular dermatologic evaluation and referral to a dermatologist or provider experienced in the diagnosis and management of cutaneous manifestations of targeted therapy is recommended. BRAF inhibitors are associated with cutaneous squamous cell carcinoma, extreme photosensitivity, and other dermatologic toxicities, which occur much less often with concurrent MEK inhibitors. Severe and life-threatening[1] skin toxicity (eg, drug-induced hypersensitivity syndrome) can occur with the use of BRAF inhibitors following immune checkpoint blockade, and requires prompt dermatologic consultation for accurate diagnosis and treatment.[2] Cutaneous toxicities of MEK inhibitors most commonly manifest as acneiform rash. Topical benzoyl peroxide with or without oral doxycycline/minocycline may be used at the onset of rash (see Management of Toxicities Associated with Targeted and Immune Therapies in the NCCN Guidelines for Melanoma: Cutaneous).
- Serious retinopathy may occur with MEK inhibitors. Monitoring by retinal exam with optical coherence tomography (OCT) is recommended.

**Considerations for Targeted Therapies**

- Patients may not be able to tolerate the full doses of tyrosine kinase inhibitors.
- It is generally reasonable to start with one or two dose reductions, and then adjust the dose based on response. See HIST-F 3 of 3.
- Consider drug-drug interactions that may occur with concurrent use of specific CYP inhibitors or inducers, along with other interacting classes, by avoiding the interacting drug or adjusting the dose of the targeted agent, as clinically indicated.

[a] Refer to full prescribing information for individual agents regarding specific and additional information (https://www.accessdata.fda.gov/scripts/cder/daf).

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## PRINCIPLES OF TARGETED THERAPY

### Recommended Starting Doses for Select Targeted Agents

| Drug | Starting Dose (Adjust/Increase Based on Response)[c] |
|---|---|
| Dabrafenib | 50 mg PO twice daily |
| Cobimetinib | 20–40 mg PO daily on days 1–21 of each 28-day cycle |
| Trametinib | 0.5–1 mg PO daily |
| Vemurafenib | 480 mg PO twice daily |

[c] Other MEK and BRAF inhibitors not listed should be started at similarly reduced doses.

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## PRINCIPLES OF RADIATION THERAPY

### Pediatric and Adult Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis

#### General Guidelines

- Common sites of involvement include: bone, skin, lymph node, liver, spleen, oral mucosa, lung, and CNS.

#### Simulation and Treatment Planning

- CT simulation and conformal treatment planning is recommended for accurate target delineation and normal tissue sparing.
- Modalities: Intensity-modulated RT (IMRT) may be used in clinical settings where reduction in dose to organs at risk is required, which cannot be achieved by three-dimensional conformal radiation (3D-CRT) techniques. Electrons may be appropriate for skin lesions.
- Image-guided RT (IGRT) is a method that may be utilized to improve accuracy of radiation treatment delivery, when integrated with advanced techniques.
- Immobilization: Customized immobilization (ie, thermoplastic masks, Vacloc bags) should be used to minimize motion.
- Four-dimensional CT (4D-CT) planning or other motion management is recommended for lesions in regions subject to motion (ie, lung) to account for respiratory and organ movement.
- Target volumes should be defined based on imaging and clinical assessment.

#### Target Volume (General Guidelines)

- Preoperative and Postoperative[1,2]
  - Target volume determination may include MRI, CT, physical exam, postoperative reports, and pathology reports.
    - Target volumes:
      - Gross tumor volume (GTV): Defined by gross/residual disease if present.
      - Clinical target volume (CTV): Includes potential microscopic disease spread based on anatomical and histologic considerations.
      - Planning target volume (PTV): Expansion based on setup uncertainties and motion management.

#### Normal Tissue Tolerance Dose-Limits

- Dose constraints should prioritize sparing of normal tissues while maintaining tumor control.

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## PRINCIPLES OF RADIATION THERAPY

### RT Dosing

- Published experience with RT for these rare tumors demonstrates favorable local control across a range of doses. Reported treatment doses generally range from 10–30 Gy, although an optimal dose within this range has not been definitively established due to the rarity of these entities.

- Panel recommendations are as follows:
  - Langerhans cell histiocytosis (osseous): 10 Gy
  - Langerhans cell histiocytosis (extraosseous): 10–30 Gy

### Other Histiocytic Neoplasms

- For ECD and RDD, available experience suggests that doses ≥20 to 30 Gy are generally required for local control.

- Panel recommendations are as follows:
  - RDD: 24–36 Gy
  - ECD: ≥20 Gy

### Malignant Histiocytic Neoplasms

- Higher doses than LCH, ECD, and RDD are required.
- For MHN, see NCCN Guidelines for Soft Tissue Sarcoma.

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## PRINCIPLES OF MOLECULAR TESTING

### MAPK and related pathway mutations

- Common MAPK or similar pathway mutations differ in frequency but overall are similar across all histiocytoses, including LCH and ECD, mixed histiocytosis, and RDD.[1-5] The most common mutations are listed below.[1]
  - *BRAF* abnormalities, including V600E mutation, other single nucleotide variants or indels, and fusions
  - *MAP2K1*
  - *KRAS*
  - Rare (less than 2%): *ARAF*, *NRAS*, *CSF1R*, *PIK3CA*
  - Less common but potentially targetable rearrangements include: *ALK* (*KIF5B::ALK*), *NTRK1*
  - Very rare (<1%): *KIT*, *MAP2K2*, *NF1*, *CBL*, *FGFR2, MAPK3, RAF1, TYK2*, *MAPK7*, *TEK*, *JAK3*, *ALK*, *MET*, *CSF3R*, *RET* fusions

- Malignant histiocytic neoplasms (histiocytic, Langerhans cell, or interdigitating dendritic cell sarcoma) in addition to those listed above commonly have *TP53* and/or *CDKN2A* mutations; a subset that are clonally related to lymphomas share mutations or rearrangements such as *IGH::BCL2*.[6,7] The need to test for these is dependent upon whether this is important to the treatment plan and/or prognosis.

- Approximately 20-30% of indeterminate dendritic cells tumors carry *ETV::NCOA2*. This may not be targetable but could be diagnostic.[8,9]

### *ALK* rearrangements[10]

- *KIF5B::ALK* fusions are the most common, whereas alternate rearrangements (non *KIF5B* partner, eg, *CLTC::ALK*, *TPM3::ALK*, *TFG::ALK*, *EML4::ALK*, and *DCTN1::ALK*) occur less frequently. Breakapart FISH or RNA sequencing are needed to detect the whole spectrum of *ALK* rearrangements. Additionally, false or equivocal positive ALK immunohistochemical staining can occur, so FISH or RNA sequencing is necessary to confirm the presence of *ALK* rearrangements. Xanthogranuloma histology is present in approximately 1/3 of *ALK*-rearranged histiocytoses.

### *NTRK1* rearrangements[11,12]

- *NTRK1* rearrangements occur more frequently in JXG over AXG and rarely occur in ECD. The most common *NTRK1* fusion partner is *IRF2BP2* followed by *TPM3* and other rare genes including *SQSTM1*, *PRDX1*, *NPM1*, *LMNA*, and *ARHGEF2*. Breakapart FISH or RNA sequencing are needed to detect the whole spectrum of *NTRK1* rearrangements. Additionally, emperipolesis is reported in JXG, so there is also histologic overlap with RDD.

### Myeloid type mutations[13,14]

- These are also frequent mutations associated with clonal hematopoiesis and/or overt myeloid neoplasia in ECD, multiple AXG, and indeterminate dendritic cell tumors but their clinical significance is currently unknown. See NCCN Guidelines for Myelodysplastic Syndromes.

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References on HIST-H 3 of 3



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## PRINCIPLES OF MOLECULAR TESTING

**Testing Recommendations**

- These can be followed sequentially or be included as comprehensive testing to the extent that they would change management.

- Sequential (particularly recommended for pediatric LCH where *BRAF V600E* makes up just over 50% of activating kinase mutations)[2]
  - *BRAF V600E*; if negative,
    - ◊ NGS panel for SNVs and small indels to include at minimum *BRAF*, *MAP2K1*, *KRAS*, *ARAF*, *NRAS*, *CSF1R*, and for malignant histiocytic neoplasm, *TP53* and *CDKN2A*
    - ◊ Targeted RNA sequencing or break apart FISH to cover *BRAF*, *NTRK1*, and *ALK* rearrangements
    - ◊ For indeterminate dendritic cell tumor, if helpful diagnostically, *ETV3::NCOA2*
    - ◊ For patients with CBC abnormalities, particularly adults with ECD/AXG, consider bone marrow biopsy with NGS myeloid gene panel.
  - For patients with malignant histiocytic neoplasms, if there is a history of hematolymphoid neoplasms or clinical presentation suspicious for secondary malignant histiocytic neoplasm, consider NGS panel or other relevant molecular testing covering common lymphoma-associated or other relevant mutations.

- Comprehensive
  - NGS to cover at minimum *BRAF*, *MAP2K1*, *KRAS*, *ARAF*, *NRAS*, *CSF1R*, *TP53* and *CDKN2A*; targeted RNA sequencing or break apart FISH to cover *BRAF*, *NTRK1*, and *ALK* rearrangements
  - For indeterminate dendritic cell tumor, CBC abnormalities and malignant histiocytic neoplasms:
    - ◊ For indeterminate dendritic cell tumor, if helpful diagnostically, *ETV3::NCOA2*
    - ◊ For patients with CBC abnormalities, particularly adults with ECD/AXG, consider bone marrow biopsy with MDS type molecular panel
    - ◊ For patients with malignant histiocytic neoplasms, if there is a history of hematolymphoid neoplasms or clinical presentation suspicious for secondary malignant histiocytic neoplasm, consider NGS panel or other relevant molecular testing covering common lymphoma-associated or other relevant mutations.

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References on HIST-H 3 of 3



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## ABBREVIATIONS

| | |
|---|---|
| 3D-CRT | three-dimensional conformal radiation |
| 4D-CT | four-dimensional computed tomography |
| ACTH | adrenocorticotropic hormone |
| ALPS | autoimmune lymphoproliferative syndrome |
| AML | acute myeloid leukemia |
| ANA | antinuclear antibody |
| ANCA | antineutrophil cytoplasmic antibody |
| AVP | arginine vasopressin |
| AXG | adult xanthogranuloma |
| CBC | complete blood count |
| CMML | chronic myelomonocytic leukemia |
| CNS | central nervous system |
| CTV | clinical target volume |
| E-ABR | electrical auditory brainstem response |
| ECD | Erdheim-Chester disease |
| ENT | ear, nose, and throat |
| ERCP | endoscopic retrograde cholangiopancreatography |
| FDG | fluorodeoxyglucose |
| FISH | fluorescence in situ hybridization |
| FSH | follicle-stimulating hormone |
| G6PD | glucose-6-phosphate dehydrogenase |
| GI | gastrointestinal |
| GTV | gross tumor volume |
| H&P | history and physical |
| HCT | hematopoietic cell transplant |
| HRCT | high-resolution computed tomography |
| ICI | immune checkpoint inhibitor |
| IGF-1 | insulin-like growth factor 1 |
| IgG4 | immunoglobulin G4 |
| IGRT | image-guided radiation therapy |
| IHC | immunohistochemistry |
| IMRT | intensity-modulated radiation therapy |
| JXG | juvenile xanthogranuloma |
| LCH | Langerhans cell histiocytosis |
| LDCT | low-dose computed tomography |
| LFT | liver function test |
| LH | luteinizing hormone |
| MDP | methylene diphosphonate |
| MDS | myelodysplastic syndrome |
| MHN | malignant histiocytic neoplasm |
| MPN | myeloproliferative neoplasm |
| MS | myeloid sarcoma |
| MS-LCH | multisystem Langerhans cell histiocytosis |
| NGS | next-generation sequencing |
| OCT | optical coherence tomography |
| PCR | polymerase chain reaction |
| PFT | pulmonary function test |
| PTV | planning target volume |
| RDD | Rosai-Dorfman disease |
| RF | rheumatoid factor |
| SLE | systemic lupus erythematosus |
| SUV | standardized uptake value |
| 99mTc | technetium-99m |
| TSH | thyroid-stimulating hormone |
| TTE | transthoracic echocardiogram |
| UVA | ultraviolet A |
| UVB | ultraviolet B |



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| NCCN Categories of Evidence and Consensus | |
|---|---|
| **Category 1** | Based upon high-level evidence (≥1 randomized phase 3 trials or high-quality, robust meta-analyses), there is uniform NCCN consensus (≥85% support of the Panel) that the intervention is appropriate. |
| **Category 2A** | Based upon lower-level evidence, there is uniform NCCN consensus (≥85% support of the Panel) that the intervention is appropriate. |
| **Category 2B** | Based upon lower-level evidence, there is NCCN consensus (≥50%, but <85% support of the Panel) that the intervention is appropriate. |
| **Category 3** | Based upon any level of evidence, there is major NCCN disagreement that the intervention is appropriate. |

All recommendations are category 2A unless otherwise indicated.

| NCCN Categories of Preference | |
|---|---|
| **Preferred** | Interventions that are based on superior efficacy, safety, and evidence; and, when appropriate, affordability. |
| **Other recommended** | Other interventions that may be somewhat less efficacious, more toxic, or based on less mature data; or significantly less affordable for similar outcomes. |
| **Useful in certain circumstances** | Other interventions that may be used for selected patient populations (defined with recommendation). |

All recommendations are considered appropriate.

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# NCCN Guidelines Version 2.2026
# Histiocytic Neoplasms

## Discussion

This discussion corresponds to the NCCN Guidelines for Histiocytic Neoplasms. Last updated: January 7, 2025.

### Table of Contents

**Overview** ..... MS-2

**Guidelines Update Methodology** ..... MS-2

**Literature Search Criteria** ..... MS-2

**Sensitive/Inclusive Language Usage** ..... MS-3

**Characteristics and Diagnostic Evaluation of Histiocytic Neoplasms** ..... MS-3

**Pathologic Analysis of Histiocytic Neoplasms** ..... MS-3

**Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis** ..... MS-4

Diagnosis of LCH ..... MS-5

Histopathologic Characterization of LCH ..... MS-6

Treatment of LCH ..... MS-7

Unifocal and Single System Disease with No Critical Organ Involvement ..... MS-7

Multisystem or Multifocal Single-System Disease or Unifocal Disease with Critical Organ Involvement or that Progresses on Local Therapy ..... MS-7

Systemic Therapy for LCH ..... MS-8

Follow-up ..... MS-11

Treatment for Relapsed/Refractory Disease ..... MS-11

**Erdheim-Chester Disease** ..... MS-11

Diagnosis of ECD ..... MS-12

Histopathologic Characterization of ECD ..... MS-13

Treatment of ECD ..... MS-14

Follow-up ..... MS-15

**Rosai-Dorfman Disease** ..... MS-15

Diagnosis of RDD ..... MS-16

Histopathologic Characterization of RDD ..... MS-17

Treatment of RDD ..... MS-18

Systemic Therapy ..... MS-18

Follow-up ..... MS-19

**Supportive Care for Patients** ..... MS-19

**Summary** ..... MS-20

**References** ..... MS-21

Discussion update in progress



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# NCCN Guidelines Version 2.2026
# Histiocytic Neoplasms

## Overview

Histiocytic neoplasms represent hematologic disorders characterized by the accumulation of myeloid-dendritic cell-derived neoplastic cells with an accompanying inflammatory infiltrate.[1,2] They are rare, accounting for less than 1% of cancers of the soft tissue and lymph nodes.[2] Histiocytic neoplasms are also heterogeneous, and presentation varies from localized and mild to disseminated and lethal.[1] Initial presentation is often nonspecific, which can lead to a significant delay in the diagnosis and treatment of histiocytic disorders,[3] and these patients should ideally be evaluated and treated at centers of expertise.

There are over 100 subtypes of histiocytoses.[1] The original classification of histiocytic neoplasms by the Working Group of the Histiocyte Society, which was published in 1987, categorized these disorders as follows: Langerhans cell, non-Langerhans cell, and malignant histiocytoses.[4] However, this categorization of histiocytic neoplasms as Langerhans/non-Langerhans was not useful, as neoplasms classified as Langerhans cell histiocytosis (LCH) were found to share many of the same molecular features as those classified as Erdheim-Chester disease (ECD), following emerging deep sequencing diagnostic methods.[1,2] For example, clonal mutations of genes in the MAPK pathway have been found in the majority of Langerhans and non-Langerhans histiocytoses.[5-8] Thus, in 2016, the Histiocyte Society published a revised classification based on clinical, radiographic, histologic, phenotypic, and other molecular features, further dividing them into five groups of diseases: 1) Langerhans-related; 2) cutaneous and mucocutaneous; 3) malignant histiocytoses; 4) Rosai-Dorfman disease (RDD); and 5) hemophagocytic lymphohistiocytosis and macrophage activation syndrome.[1]

The NCCN Clinical Practice Guidelines (NCCN Guidelines®) for Histiocytic Neoplasms include recommendations for the diagnosis and treatment of adults with LCH, ECD, and RDD, which are the most commonly seen histiocytic neoplasms in adults. The evidence supporting the management of histiocytic neoplasms in adults is largely based on small retrospective studies, case series, and case reports, due to the paucity of prospective studies in adults. In addition, some of the diagnostic and treatment recommendations for adults with histiocytic neoplasms are, out of necessity, extrapolated from prospective studies in children and young adults, except when stated otherwise.

## Guidelines Update Methodology

The complete details of the Development and Update of the NCCN Guidelines are available at www.NCCN.org.

## Literature Search Criteria

Prior to the annual update of the NCCN Guidelines® for Histiocytic Neoplasms, an electronic search of the PubMed database was performed to obtain key literature published since the previous update, using the search terms: (histiocyt* OR ("Langerhans cell") OR (Erdheim-Chester) OR (Rosai-Dorfman)) AND (cancer OR oncology OR neoplasm). The PubMed database was chosen because it remains the most widely used resource for medical literature and indexes peer-reviewed biomedical literature.[9]

The search results were narrowed by selecting studies in humans published in English. Results were confined to the following article types: Clinical Trial, Phase II; Clinical Trial, Phase III; Clinical Trial, Phase IV; Guideline; Practice Guideline; Randomized Controlled Trial; Meta-Analysis; Systematic Reviews; and Validation Studies. The data from key PubMed articles as well as articles from additional sources deemed relevant to these guidelines as discussed by the Panel have been included in this version of the Discussion section.

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Recommendations for which high-level evidence is lacking are based on the Panel's review of lower-level evidence and expert opinion.

## Sensitive/Inclusive Language Usage

NCCN Guidelines strive to use language that advances the goals of equity, inclusion, and representation.[10] NCCN Guidelines endeavor to use language that is person-first; not stigmatizing; anti-racist, anti-classist, anti-misogynist, anti-ageist, anti-ableist, and anti-weight-biased; and inclusive of individuals of all sexual orientations and gender identities. NCCN Guidelines incorporate non-gendered language, instead focusing on organ-specific recommendations. This language is both more accurate and more inclusive and can help fully address the needs of individuals of all sexual orientations and gender identities. NCCN Guidelines will continue to use the terms men, women, female, and male when citing statistics, recommendations, or data from organizations or sources that do not use inclusive terms. Most studies do not report how sex and gender data are collected and use these terms interchangeably or inconsistently. If sources do not differentiate gender from sex assigned at birth or organs present, the information is presumed to predominantly represent cisgender individuals. NCCN encourages researchers to collect more specific data in future studies and organizations to use more inclusive and accurate language in their future analyses.

## Characteristics and Diagnostic Evaluation of Histiocytic Neoplasms

Characteristics of LCH, ECD, and RDD involve features across multiple organ systems, including the bone, nervous, endocrine, respiratory, dermatologic, and cardiac systems, among others.[3] These diverse clinical manifestations mimic other conditions, posing a major diagnostic challenge. For a more detailed list of characteristic features of ECD, LCH, and RDD, see *Characteristic Features of Histiocytic Neoplasms* in the algorithm.

For patients with suspected disease, a complete medical history and physical (H&P) examination should be conducted along with laboratory tests, including a complete blood count (CBC) with differential, a comprehensive metabolic panel that includes liver and kidney function assessments, evaluation of C-reactive protein, morning urine and serum osmolality, morning serum cortisol with adrenocorticotropic hormone (ACTH), thyroid-stimulating hormone (TSH) plus free T4, follicle-stimulating hormone/luteinizing hormone (FSH/LH) with testosterone or estradiol, and prolactin and insulin-like growth factor 1. A bone marrow aspirate/biopsy should be performed if the patient has an abnormal, unexplained CBC, and, if brain lesions are present but inaccessible by biopsy, a lumbar puncture should also be conducted. Subspecialty consultations (eg, pulmonary and smoking cessation, neurology, endocrinology) should be carried out as clinically indicated. Dermatology consultation is recommended for patients treated with certain targeted therapies (ie, BRAF and MEK inhibitors) for diagnosis and treatment of skin-related toxicities.[11] Retinal evaluation may be considered due to the high incidence of serious retinopathy with MEK inhibitors.[12,13] See *Principles of Diagnostic Evaluation* in the algorithm for a full assessment list.

## Pathologic Analysis of Histiocytic Neoplasms

Immunohistochemical (IHC) analysis plays an important role in the diagnosis of histiocytic neoplasms and should be carried out when a histiocytic neoplasm is suspected. The basic IHC panel should include CD163/CD68, S100, CD1a, Langerin/CD207, cyclin D1, and factor XIIIa as indicated.[3] *BRAF* V600E (VE1) IHC is recommended for LCH and ECD. It should be noted that negative or equivocal IHC for *BRAF* V600E VE1 does not exclude mutated *BRAF* V600E and further testing

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may be required. Anaplastic lymphoma kinase (ALK) and fascin may also be included as clinically indicated to identify *ALK*-rearranged histiocytoses.[14] IHC analysis can be helpful in the broad differential diagnosis of histiocytosis, including varied entities such as composite IgG4-related disease and B-cell lymphoma, as well as infection, fat necrosis, and idiopathic retroperitoneal fibrosis.[3]

Next-generation sequencing (NGS) of fresh or paraffin-embedded tumor tissue for identification of mutations in the RAS/RAF/MAPK/ERK and PI3K/AKT pathway genes can be instrumental in the diagnosis of histiocytic neoplasms and can also inform systemic therapy decision-making.[3] Peripheral blood may be informative of multisystem disease. Additionally, fusion testing should be performed to assess for *BRAF*, *ALK*, *RET*, and *NTRK1* rearrangements. Of note, fusion testing is recommended if histiocytosis is clinically suspected and the NGS panel does not reveal *BRAF* or other MAPK mutations.[15] If fusion panel testing is unavailable, then IHC or fluorescence in situ hybridization (FISH) may be used to evaluate for *ALK* rearrangements. Molecular testing can be done either in a stepwise fashion or in parallel, depending on clinical indication and institutional protocols. If a specific histiocytic disorder is suspected, then stepwise testing should be tailored based on the mutations known to be associated with that disorder.[15] Further details regarding recommendations for pathologic analysis related to LCH, ECD, and RDD are included below. A complete list of immunophenotypes and molecular features to include in the evaluation can also be found on the *Summary of Pathologic and Molecular Features of Histiocytic Neoplasms* pages in the algorithm.

## Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis

LCH is the most common histiocytic disorder and occurs more frequently in children than adults. The incidence of disseminated LCH is estimated to be 5 to 9 cases per 1 million in children (>15 years) and 0.07 cases per 1 million in adults (>18 years).[16-18] A study examining SEER registry data in the United States showed that 5-year overall survival for adults with LCH was 88.5%, but, while many cases are mild and asymptomatic, rapidly progressing and/or disseminated life-threatening disease that is resistant to treatment may also occur.[19] The Histiocyte Society's initial 1987 classification categorized LCH as an immunologic inflammatory disease but not as a neoplasm.[4] However, presence of clonal histiocytes supports the neoplastic origin of LCH.[20,21] Recurrent activating mutations in the MAPK pathway are found in the vast majority of cases.[8,22] These discoveries support the WHO's classification of histiocytic disorders, particularly LCH as a neoplastic process.[23] In the Histiocyte Society's revised classification, four categories of LCH are identified: single system, pulmonary-involved, multisystem with risk organ involvement, and multisystem without risk organ involvement.[1]

Common sites of involvement of LCH include bone, skin, pituitary gland, liver, spleen, bone marrow, lungs, and lymph nodes.[24] There is also a high prevalence of concomitant and subsequent malignancies, especially solid tumors or myeloid malignancies, in adults with LCH.[18,25] A pulmonary form of LCH can occur in adults and is associated with smoking.[21,26,27] Multifocal bone lesions without the involvement of other organs may also be observed in some cases, and bone mineral density may be lower than the expected range in adults with LCH.[28] Permanent endocrinopathy is common in LCH, such as diabetes insipidus (now referred to arginine vasopressin [AVP] deficiency), which more commonly occurs with multisystem disease.[21,29,30] Though there are cases of solitary central nervous system (CNS)-involved LCH, CNS involvement is most often accompanied with multi-system disease.[24] CNS-involved LCH can present as space-occupying granulomatous tumors, frequently in the hypothalamic-pituitary region but also involving the choroid plexus, meninges, grey or white matter, or as

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neurodegenerative LCH (ND-LCH) lesions in the cerebellum and brain stem.[31] The bone lesions in the mastoid, sphenoid, orbit, temporal bone, and clivus represent CNS-risk lesions, indicating increased risk of developing CNS-involved LCH.[31] ND-LCH is frequent in patients with pituitary, skin, and base-of-skull bone involvement. A study of children and young adults with LCH (N = 1897) showed that a *BRAF* mutation was present in 93.7% of patients with ND-LCH, compared to 54.1% in patients without ND-LCH.[32] The 10-year risk of developing neurodegenerative disease is 33.1% in patients with a *BRAF* mutation, compared to 2.9% in patients without a *BRAF* mutation (*P* = .002).

### Diagnosis of LCH

Initial diagnostic testing is dependent on clinical presentation. Essential workup for LCH involves a comprehensive H&P examination with specific attention to common sites of involvement, including the skin; head, eyes, ears, nose, and throat (HEENT); bone, lymph node, liver, spleen, lung, and CNS.[21,33] Whole-body fluorodeoxyglucose (FDG)-PET/CT, including distal extremities, should be performed along with pulmonary function tests (PFTs) to evaluate for obstructive airway disease, air trapping, and carbon monoxide diffusing capacity.[21,26] FDG-PET/CT is superior to other cross-sectional imaging techniques for detection of sites of active LCH, with the exception of pulmonary lesions.[34-36] Bone involvement, which may appear as aggressive cortically-based lytic lesions, is also best detected using full-body (vertex-to-toes) FDG-PET/CT.[3] It is controversial whether whole-body imaging is required for every patient with LCH, such as those presenting only with skin involvement, or those with symptoms limited to the lungs. However, whether a patient's LCH is single or multisystem is unknown in the absence of imaging and should be considered for patients with suspected multisystem disease. High-resolution CT of the chest for suspected pulmonary LCH is recommended as it[33] may detect nodules ≤2 mm in the early stages of pulmonary LCH, and irregular cysts in the lungs may be observed in advanced disease.[3,21] Laboratory tests, including those mentioned in the earlier *Characteristics and Diagnostic Evaluation of Histiocytic Neoplasms* section of this Discussion, are also part of the essential workup for LCH.[21,33]

Further workup may be useful depending on symptoms or organ involvement. Additional imaging can be conducted including: CT with contrast of the chest, abdomen, and pelvis and MRI with and without contrast of the brain, spine, and sella turcica with or without pituitary evaluation, if AVP deficiency is suspected. Abnormal brain MRI is often observed in LCH, even in the absence of neurologic symptoms.[24] Findings on brain MRI can mimic primary CNS tumors, brain metastases, or inflammatory granulomatous diseases.[24] In ND-LCH, signal changes in white and deep gray matter with cortical atrophy may be observed with MRI.[31] In cases that manifest with AVP deficiency, the earliest change seen on MRI may be an enlargement of the pituitary stalk, and later the space-occupying tumors extending to the pituitary gland and hypothalamus. There is typically a ''loss of bright spot'' (ie, the lack of the physiologic hyperintense signal in the posterior pituitary on T1-weighted images), which is secondary to the loss of antidiuretic hormone-containing granules. Not all patients with AVP deficiency will have an abnormal MRI.

Ultrasound of the abdomen allows for determination of hepatic and spleen involvement, and other imaging techniques such as endoscopic retrograde cholangiopancreatography and digital panoramic dental x-ray can also be performed as clinically indicated. Right heart catheterization should be performed if pulmonary hypertension is suspected, and transthoracic echocardiogram (TTE) is also recommended to screen for pulmonary hypertension.[3] Endocrine evaluation is encouraged for those with detected endocrinopathy or pituitary hypothalamic involvement. Comprehensive neurocognitive and

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psychological assessments should be included for select patients.[21] The complete recommendations for evaluation of LCH are provided in the algorithm (see *Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis: Workup/Evaluation*) and are adapted from recommendations in the consensus statement by the Mayo Clinic Histiocytosis Working Group[3]

While diagnosis of LCH is based on clinical and radiologic findings, biopsy of tumor tissue is also recommended (see *Histopathologic Characterization of LCH* below in this Discussion).[21] Morphologically, in LCH, histiocytes with grooved nuclei are observed along with eosinophilia. IHC analysis of tumor tissue, which should include a minimal panel of CD1a, S100, and Langerin as well as cyclin D1 and *BRAF* V600E VE1 IHC, is recommended at this time along with NGS and gene fusion assays to evaluate for somatic genetic variants of the MAPK and other related pathways (see *Histopathologic Characterization of LCH* below for more information). If biopsy is not possible due to location or other risk factors, mutational analysis of peripheral blood is an option. If a patient has an unexplained, abnormal CBC, a bone marrow biopsy should also be considered to rule out hemophagocytic lymphohistiocytosis or myeloid neoplasm. Because LCH frequently presents with lytic bone lesions, differential diagnosis may include multiple myeloma and metastatic bone involvement from other cancers. Skin involvement may be mistaken for seborrheic dermatitis, eczema, psoriasis, Candida infection, intertrigo, and lichen planus.[21] Langerhans cell hyperplasia can be associated with mycosis fungoides, which could be misinterpreted as a composite LCH.[37] Differential diagnosis for single-system pulmonary LCH includes hypersensitivity pneumonitis, interstitial pneumonia, pulmonary lymphangioleiomyomatosis, and sarcoidosis.

***Histopathologic Characterization of LCH***

Cytologic features typically observed with LCH include an oval-shaped nucleus that is retiform with irregular nuclear contours, an inconspicuous nucleoli, and abundant cytoplasm.[15] On hematoxylin and eosin (H&E) stain, neoplastic LCH cells are mononucleated, typically with a coffee bean-shaped nucleus.[1,22,38] LCH tumors often demonstrate neoplastic histiocytes admixed with marked inflammatory cell infiltration. Abundant eosinophils and multinucleated giant cells are frequently observed.[1-3] Pathology of lesions from LCH-associated abnormal CNS imaging (LACI) and LCH-associated abnormal CNS symptoms (LACS) show infiltrating CD8+ lymphocytes, and, unlike other LCH tumors, lack CD1a-positive histiocytes.[39] Birbeck granules can be identified by electron microscope, which is, however, now not commonly performed. Fibrosis may be present, particularly in bone lesions.[3]

IHC analysis of LCH tumors demonstrates abundant CD1a- and CD207- (Langerin) positive neoplastic histiocytes that are also positive for S100 and cyclin D1.[3,22,38] Cyclin D1 can be helpful for differentiating neoplastic Langerhans cells from reactive Langerhans cell proliferation.[40,41] Activation of RAS-RAF-MAPK pathway is universal in all patients with LCH.[5,42] A *BRAF* V600E activating mutation is the most prevalent, presenting in 38% to 64% of LCH cases, and carries prognostic significance. [5,6,43-47] This mutation is more frequent in mixed LCH/ECD, when compared to isolated LCH or ECD.[48] Thus, *BRAF* V600E (VE1) should also be evaluated using IHC. However, studies evaluating IHC versus PCR testing of *BRAF* V600E mutations in pediatric patients with LCH (using stringent scoring criteria[49]) showed sensitivity values ranging from 35.6% to 80%; specificity values ranged from 75.5% to 100%.[50,51] *BRAF* V600E allele-specific PCR is recommended if IHC is unavailable or when *BRAF* V600E (VE1) IHC results are equivocal or negative. Mutations in *MAP2K1/2* are also prevalent in LCH (~20%) and are mutually exclusive with *BRAF* V600E

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mutations.[8,43,47,52] *KRAS*, *NRAS*, *ARAF*, and *CSF1R* mutations are less frequently observed in LCH.[15,53] Therefore, evaluation of tumor tissue by NGS to determine somatic variants in the MAPK pathway genes (*BRAF*, *ARAF*, *NRAS*, *KRAS*, *MAP2K1/2*) and other related pathway mutations, such as *PIK3CA* and *CSF1R*, along with gene fusion assays that cover *BRAF*, *ALK*, *RET*, and *NTRK1* rearrangements, are recommended. ALK IHC and FISH studies can be used if there is a concern for *ALK* rearrangement and fusion panel testing is not available. For complete recommendations regarding pathologic analysis of LCH cases, see the *Principles of Pathology* section in the algorithm.

### Treatment of LCH

Much of the evidence for treatment of LCH is extrapolated from prospective studies of children and adolescents. Studies of adults with LCH are limited to case series and retrospective studies. Treatment decisions for LCH should be made based on sites and extent of disease.[21]

#### *Unifocal and Single System Disease with No Critical Organ Involvement*

For patients with single system disease and no involvement of critical organs (ie, CNS, liver, spleen), treatment is limited to local therapy (surgical excision or RT) and observation.[21]

Limited curettage is recommended for patients with isolated bone lesions,[54] but complete resection of bone lesions is not recommended, as this may result in an increase in the size of the bony defect and permanent skeletal defects.[21] Corticosteroid injection, with triamcinolone or equivalent, may facilitate healing after limited curettage.[21] Low-dose radiation therapy for treatment of bone-involved LCH is associated with excellent local disease control.[55,56] For patients with single system bone disease, radiation therapy may be used for some patients with limited sites of disease, specifically in cases with impending neurologic dysfunction and if surgical risk is high.[21] "Limited" sites of disease is generally defined as 1 to 2 lesions in this context, though radiation therapy may be considered for up to three bone lesions as clinically indicated. The recommended radiation dose for treatment of bone-involved LCH in adults is 10 to 20 Gy.[21,55] Bisphosphonate therapy is preferred if bone lesions are not amenable to local therapies due to size and location (See *Principles of Systemic Therapy* in the algorithm). Observation is also reasonable for asymptomatic and isolated bone lesions.

For patients with single system isolated skin disease, topical therapies may be used.[54] Case reports describing treatment of older adults with cutaneous LCH support the use of psoralen with ultraviolet A (PUVA) or narrowband ultraviolet B (UVB).[57,58] Other topical therapies such as nitrogen mustard (eg, mechlorethamine) and steroids (triamcinolone injection or equivalent corticosteroid) are alternative options that have been shown to be effective in children with cutaneous LCH,[59,60] though there are no published data in adults with LCH. Surgery should only be performed for solitary skin lesions, and only for those in which surgery will not result in disfigurement. Low-dose RT is also an option for these patients, and systemic therapy may be used for symptomatic disease including pain, secondary infection, or if there are complications from skin lesions.[54] Isolated skin-involved LCH has been reported to resolve spontaneously,[61] so observation is also an option for these patients.

#### *Multisystem or Multifocal Single-System Disease or Unifocal Disease with Critical Organ Involvement or that Progresses on Local Therapy*

Systemic therapy is often required for the treatment of multisystem LCH, multifocal single system LCH, unifocal disease involving a critical organ such as CNS, liver, spleen, or unifocal disease that progresses on local therapy (see *Systemic Therapy for LCH*, described below). However, if asymptomatic or if there is no impending organ dysfunction, observation may be considered. Imaging changes precede clinical

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progression in ND-LCH, warranting consideration of early treatment, and cognitive symptoms should be carefully evaluated and monitored. Bisphosphonates (eg, zoledronic acid or pamidronate) are recommended for treatment of multifocal bone disease, which is supported by small retrospective studies and case series.[62,63] In the absence of disease response following treatment with a bisphosphonate, other systemic therapy regimens may be considered (see *Systemic Therapy for LCH*, described below). Radiation therapy can also be considered in patients with persistent disease with limited disease sites following systemic treatment.[21,64]

Since pulmonary LCH is associated with smoking, treatment should include smoking cessation (see the NCCN Guidelines for Smoking Cessation, available at www.NCCN.org). Pulmonary LCH could resolve with smoking cessation alone.[54] Therefore, observation is an option, particularly in patients with asymptomatic disease or who have minor symptoms. Systemic therapy can be considered in patients with symptomatic and/or progressive pulmonary LCH, as well as in patients with persistent disease despite smoking cessation (see *Systemic Therapy for LCH*, described below). High-dose prednisone (1 mg/kg/day for 1 month, followed by a slow taper) can also be effective in treatment of pulmonary LCH.[21] Steroid treatment is often associated with radiographic improvements in pulmonary LCH but may not improve the respiratory function.[65] Lung transplant should be considered only in select patients with highly refractory and severe disease.[54]

***Systemic Therapy for LCH***

Systemic therapy is the standard treatment in the first- or subsequent-line settings for multisystem and/or multifocal LCH, but responses to commonly used regimens in adults with LCH tend to be less robust compared to children. Preferred systemic therapy regimens for multisystem or single-system lung LCH and LCH CNS lesions currently include vemurafenib for *BRAF* V600E mutated disease, cobimetinib for patients with MAP kinase pathway mutation, no other detectable/actionable mutation, or if testing is not available, and cytarabine or cladribine, irrespective of mutation.

Prior to 2012, there were relatively few effective treatment options for histiocytic neoplasms. The discovery of *BRAF* V600E and other gene mutations resulting in overactive MAPK pathway in histiocytic neoplasms led to a promising avenue of targeted therapies for patients with these rare cancers. The phase II VE-BASKET study evaluated the efficacy of BRAF inhibitor vemurafenib.[66] The final efficacy and safety analysis included 26 adults with *BRAF* V600E-mutated LCH or ECD (85% ECD) and showed an overall response rate (ORR) of 61.5% (95% CI, 40.6%–79.8%).[67] Two-year progression-free survival (PFS) and overall survival (OS) rates were 86% (95% CI, 72%–100%) and 96% (95% CI, 87%–100%), respectively. Median PFS and OS were not reached. A metabolic response as measured with FDG-PET/CT was achieved in all of the patients who were evaluated (n = 15; 80% complete response [CR], 20% partial response [PR]). The most common grade 3–4 adverse events were hypertension (27%), maculopapular rash (23%), increased lipase (15%), arthralgia (12%), hyperkeratosis (8%), and actinic keratosis (8%). All patients required dose reduction due to toxicities.

There is also evidence supporting the use of MEK inhibitors for treatment of histiocytic neoplasms. The MEK inhibitor cobimetinib was evaluated in a phase II trial including 18 adult patients diagnosed with a histiocytic neoplasm (67% ECD, 11% LCH, 11% RDD, and 11% mixed histiocytosis).[12] The ORR was 89% (one-sided 90% CI, 73%–100%), with a CR having been observed in 72% of patients. Median duration of response (DOR) and PFS were not reached after a median follow-up of 11.9 months. The most common adverse events that led to a dose



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reduction were ejection fraction decrease (27.8%), rash (11.1%), and diarrhea (11.1%). Though a mutation in the MAPK pathway was detected in 83% of patients, the efficacy of cobimetinib was not limited to these patients, indicating that cobimetinib can be used in any patient with a histiocytic disorder for whom systemic therapy is indicated. Adverse events in patients with histiocytic disorders treated with BRAF and MEK inhibitors are consistent with those observed in previously published studies (eg, rash, pyrexia),[22] but the VE-BASKET trial showed that rates of hypertension and skin-related adverse events were higher in histiocytic neoplasms than previously observed in patients with metastatic melanoma.[67]

Cladribine is a chemotherapy option that has been shown to be active in adults with LCH. A recent single-center phase II trial of 61 newly diagnosed adults with LCH revealed an ORR of 93.4% with 20 patients achieving a complete response and 37 demonstrating a partial response.[68] Moreover, the estimated 3-year OS and EFS were 100% and 58.8%, respectively.[68] Neutropenia, thrombocytopenia, and nausea were the most common grade 3–4 toxicities.[68] However, for patients who received cladribine as part of single-center retrospective study in 58 patients with bone-involved LCH, 59% did not respond to treatment or relapsed in the first year while the chemotherapy, cytarabine, showed lower toxicity with grade 3–4 adverse events being reported in 20% of patients who received cytarabine, compared to 37% who received cladribine. Low-dose cytarabine is better tolerated in adults, but higher doses should be used for patients with CNS lesions.

Other recommended regimens for patients with multisystem or single-system lung LCH or CNS lesions include: dabrafenib for *BRAF* V600E-mutated disease, trametinib, binimetinib, or selumetinib for MAP kinase pathway mutation or no other detectable/actionable mutation, or for those for whom testing was not available. Encouraging results from a case series support the use of dabrafenib, a second-generation BRAF inhibitor, in adults with LCH. Dabrafenib may be better tolerated than vemurafenib based on this case series, although there was no prospective head-to-head comparison.[69] Use of dabrafenib in patients with ND-LCH led to rapid symptomatic and radiographic improvement. Use of the MEK inhibitor trametinib for treatment of LCH is supported by case series and case reports.[70-72] In one case report, a combination of dabrafenib and trametinib demonstrated a sustained response in an adult woman with *BRAF* V600E-mutated LCH.[73] Binimetinib or selumetinib are recommended if neither cobimetinib or trametinib are not tolerated.

Methotrexate plus cytarabine, hydroxyurea, clofarabine, vinblastine/prednisone, or oral methotrexate, are also other recommended regimens for patients with multisystem or single-system lung LCH, irrespective of mutation while high-dose methotrexate or methotrexate plus cytarabine are other recommended regimens for patients with CNS lesions. A prospective single-center phase II trial from China examined combination of cytarabine (100 mg/m$^2$) and methotrexate (1 g/m$^2$) as treatment for adults with multisystem or single system multifocal LCH (N = 83). ORR, 3-year OS, and 3-year event-free survival (EFS) were 87.9%, 97.7%, and 68.0%, respectively.[74] The long-term follow-up of this study recently indicated that, after a median follow-up of 6.5 years, the ORR, 6-year OS, and 6-year EFS were 89.5%, 93.2%, and 55.2%, respectively.[75] Additionally, a retrospective study conducted at a hospital in China examined cytarabine and methotrexate combination in adults with multisystem pulmonary-involved LCH (N = 29). Pulmonary function was stable in 72.4% (n = 24), improved in 13.8% (n = 4), and deteriorated in 13.8% (n = 4) of patients.[76] Since both cytarabine and methotrexate cross the blood-brain barrier, this combination regimen may be ideal for treatment of CNS-involved LCH.[74] Vinblastine plus prednisone is the preferred



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chemotherapy-based treatment for LCH in the pediatric setting.[22] In a retrospective study conducted at a single center including 58 adults with bone-involved LCH, use of vinblastine and prednisone was associated with worse outcomes. In this study, 84% of patients who received vinblastine and prednisone developed progressive disease within the first year, compared to 21% of patients who received cytarabine (OR, 20.3; 95% CI, 4.20–98.20; $P < .001$).[77] There is also evidence supporting clofarabine for relapsed/refractory LCH in the pediatric setting, with disease improvement observed in 73% of 11 patients.[78] Neutropenia occurred in all patients.

High-dose methotrexate is also an option for CNS-involved LCH, based on a case report of a patient with CNS-involved ECD while low-dose oral methotrexate has been shown to be effective and non-toxic in a case report of a 40-year-old patient with LCH, which was also supported in children treated with low-dose methotrexate plus prednisone for low-risk LCH.[79-81] In addition, hydroxyurea demonstrated promising activity with 80% of patients demonstrating either a PR or CR with minimal toxicities.[82]

Targeted therapies may be useful in certain circumstances for patients with multisystem or single system lung LCH or CNS lesions and include: crizotinib for *ALK* fusion, pexidartinib for *CSF1R* mutation, larotrectinib, entrectinib, or repotrectinib for *NTRK* gene fusions, sirolimus or everolimus for *PIK3CA* mutation, or selpercatinib for *RET* fusion. Activating mutations in *CSF1R* and rearrangements involving *RET* and *ALK* in rare cases of LCH highlight the potential clinical benefit of other kinase inhibitors and should be considered in select cases with such alterations.[53] Since *NTRK* fusions can occur in histiocytic disorders,[83] the TRK inhibitors larotrectinib,[84] entrectinib,[85] and repotrectinib[86] may also be used as indicated. Sirolimus and everolimus can be effective for *PIK3CA*-mutated LCH, based on extrapolation of data from patients with ECD (see *Treatment of ECD* in this Discussion, below).[7,87] It is of note that targeted therapies can be started at lower doses. Additionally, allogeneic hematopoietic cell transplant is recommended for highly select patients with multisystem or single-system lung LCH.[88]

For bone disease only LCH, preferred regimens include bisphosphonates, which were discussed earlier in this Discussion. For multifocal single-system bone disease not responsive to bisphosphonates, the preferred, other recommended and useful in certain circumstances options mentioned earlier in this Discussion for multisystem disease can be considered.

Single-system multifocal skin disease can be treated with oral methotrexate or hydroxyurea (both preferred regimens) or lenalidomide or thalidomide (both other recommended regimens). Small retrospective studies and case reports support this use of specific chemotherapy options for multifocal skin-involved LCH. A single-center retrospective study evaluated hydroxyurea monotherapy and in combination with oral methotrexate in 15 patients with relapsed/refractory LCH (mostly skin-involved) with a median age of 41.2 years (range, 2–73 years).[82] An ORR of 80.0% was observed, and symptom progression or relapse after initial response was observed in 40%, with median time to progression of 5.7 months. Grade 3–4 adverse events were reported in only two patients. Retrospective data also support use of oral methotrexate combined with prednisone in children with low-risk LCH (ie, no bone marrow involvement or organ dysfunction) that was mostly bone- and/or skin-involved.[80] Thalidomide was evaluated in a phase II study including 12 children and four adults with LCH.[89] Among 10 patients with low-risk disease (involvement of skin, lungs, and lymph nodes), an ORR of 70% was observed (4 CRs, 3 PRs). All but one patient, who had low-risk disease, had skin involvement. Administration of this drug was associated with significant toxicity and should be

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avoided in patients with critical organ involvement, for whom this drug was not effective. A case report also describes a CR from lenalidomide in an adult with relapsed/refractory multisystem LCH (involvement of skin, lungs, and lymph nodes).[90]

### Follow-up

Imaging (FDG-PET/CT [preferred], CT/MRI) of involved sites to evaluate treatment response should be done after 2 to 3 cycles of systemic therapy and after completion of treatment. It should also be performed after completion of surgical curettage and after RT. LCH may relapse or reactivate following systemic therapy, which most commonly occurs in the first 2 years following treatment.[54] Development of AVP deficiency after treatment may be a sign of disease reactivation.[54] Follow-up assessment depends on extent of disease and organ involvement, and a complete list of recommendations for surveillance following treatment of LCH can be found in the algorithm (see *Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis: Follow-up* in the algorithm.

#### *Treatment for Relapsed/Refractory Disease*

In relapsed and refractory LCH, an alternate systemic therapy regimen other than the one used in the first line may be utilized. However, if DOR to the first-line regimen was >1 year, repeating the same treatment may also be considered.[21]

## Erdheim-Chester Disease

ECD is a rare histiocytic neoplasm, with approximately 1500 cases having been reported worldwide as of 2020. An increase in detection of cases has been observed over time, potentially due to improved recognition of this disease through imaging and pathology.[15,24,91] ECD predominantly affects adults and is rarely observed in children, with a median age of approximately 45 years in the United States, and is more common in men than women.[15,24,91] Mixed ECD/LCH is fairly common, with LCH lesions reported in 20% of patients with ECD.[48]

Similar to LCH, ECD presentation can range from single system and asymptomatic disease to severe multisystem and life-threatening disease. Prognosis is predominantly influenced by specific organ involvement.[91] Bone involvement affects almost all patients with ECD, with lower extremity bone pain being an especially common initial presenting symptom. Cardiovascular involvement, including pericardial disease, is reported to occur in about half of all patients[92-94] and is associated with poor prognosis.[95] Other affected organs/systems include the lungs, endocrine system, skin, and kidneys.[24,96] Periarterial fibrosis of the thoracic and/or abdominal aorta, referred to as “coated aorta,” is also commonly observed.[91,93,95,97-100] Retroperitoneal involvement tends to be asymptomatic, but extension to the renal sinus or middle to distal ureters may result in hydronephrosis.[101-103] CNS involvement occurs in 15% to 55% of cases[24,91,104] and is associated with worse prognosis.[105] Some ECD-related CNS lesions cause intracranial vascular infiltration, putting these patients at risk of ischemic stroke. AVP deficiency is the most common endocrine disorder in ECD, affecting about 25% to 50% of patients.[3,91,106] Other commonly observed endocrine manifestations of ECD include hyperprolactinemia, hypogonadism, adrenal insufficiency, and hypothyroidism.[3,106] Exophthalmos is also fairly common in ECD, and xanthelasma of the eyelids and periorbital spaces is a common cutaneous manifestation of ECD.[1,91] Involvement of the facial bones and maxillary sinuses has also been seen.[97]

Two retrospective studies demonstrated that a concomitant myeloid neoplasm can occur in 3% to 10% of ECD[107,108]; the higher rate (10%) in one study is likely due to inclusion of patients with mixed LCH/ECD.[107] In one case series, median age of patients with ECD and

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a concomitant myeloid neoplasm was 65.4 years and tended to affect more men than women (male:female ratio = 2:1).[109]

### Diagnosis of ECD

The diagnosis of ECD is largely made based on characteristic clinical and radiographic abnormalities. H&P is part of the essential workup for ECD with special attention needed to the common sites of involvement: the long bones (bilateral and symmetric diaphyseal and metaphyseal osteosclerosis with subchondral sparing); orbits (retro-orbital mass with exophthalmos; zanthelasma); CNS (pituitary gland, posterior fossa); lungs (interstitial changes); vascular (periaortic infiltrate; pericardium, right atrium); retroperitoneal/perinephritic or "hairy kidney". The presence of hairy kidney is highly suggestive of ECD and is present in 50% to 68% of patients while periarterial infiltration involving the thoracic or abdominal aorta and other vessels is present in 56% to 85% of patients with ECD.[3] Laboratory tests should also be conducted, and, similar to LCH, should include CBC, blood chemistry, coagulation studies, TSH, free T4, morning urine and serum osmolality, morning serum cortisol with ACTH, prolactin, IGF-1, and FSH/LH with testosterone or estradiol. C-reactive protein should also be evaluated, as it is often elevated in patients with ECD.[3,24] Whole-body FDG-PET/CT scan, which should include distal extremities, is also recommended along with a tissue biopsy as part of the essential workup for ECD. Full-body (vertex-to-toes) FDG-PET/CT is preferred to bone scan, as it allows for evaluation of metadiaphyseal osteosclerosis of the knees as well as other organ involvement.[3,15] Bilateral, symmetric diaphyseal, and metaphyseal osteosclerosis of the long bones of lower extremities is a characteristic finding of ECD.[2,3,15,24] In fact, bilateral symmetrical osteosclerosis of the metadiaphyseal bones around the knees is very common (>95%) and is pathognomonic of ECD.[3]

Additional evaluation is based on symptoms or organ involvement. CT of the chest, abdomen, and pelvis with contrast, sinuses with contrast, high-resolution CT of the chest, or MRI with and without contrast of the brain, orbit, spin, and sella turcica with or without pituitary (if AVP deficiency is suspected) are encouraged. CNS involvement may be detected using brain MRI with gadolinium contrast, and common findings include cerebellar and brain stem hyperintensities, cerebral white matter enhancement, and thickening of the pituitary stalk.[3,24] "Coated aorta" may be detected with CT, and arterial lesions characterized by circumferential thickening may be observed.[3,24,91,102] "Hairy kidney" detected on abdominal CT is characteristic of ECD (rarely seen in RDD and not seen in LCH) due to diffuse bilateral infiltration leading to stellate pattern of perinephric soft tissue thickening.[3,102] Adrenal hypertrophy may be observed if the perirenal infiltration extends to the adrenal gland.[102] In ECD with pulmonary involvement, chest CT may demonstrate mediastinal infiltration, pleural thickening, pleural effusion, and other pulmonary parenchymal abnormalities.[3] PFTs, TTE (especially for suspected pulmonary ECD), renal artery and testicular US, as well as technetium-99m MDP bone scintigraphy are also useful under certain circumstances. Cardiac involvement can also be determined with echocardiography and/or cardiac MRI. Findings and radiographic abnormalities include pericardial thickening, pericardial effusion, and myocardial infiltration, which, if present, most often involve the right atrioventricular groove and right atrial wall.[3] Subspecialty consultations (eg, neurology, endocrinology, nephrology, urology) should be carried out as clinically indicated. As with LCH, dermatology and ophthalmology evaluations may be considered for management of toxicities associated with BRAF and MEK inhibitors.[11-13] The complete recommendations for evaluation of ECD are provided in the algorithm and are adapted from recommendations from an expert consensus group[15] (see *Erdheim-Chester Disease: Workup/Evaluation* in the algorithm.

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A biopsy of tumor tissue is recommended for all patients, and a bone marrow biopsy should be considered in those with unexplained CBC abnormalities, such as sustained cytopenia or cytosis without explainable etiology, to rule out myeloid neoplasms. Differential diagnosis should include evaluation for IgG4-related disease, which has a clinical presentation similar to that for ECD.[24] If ECD is present, the biopsy will show foamy histiocytes and Touton giant cells; however, this may be obscured by fibrosis or lymphoplasmacytic infiltrate.[110] IHC analysis should also be performed and include, at a minimum, evaluation of: CD68 or CD163+, S100, factor XIIa, and CD1a. *BRAF* V600E (VE1) IHC is also recommended. Allele-specific PCR for *BRAF* V600E mutations can be the first step if VE1 is not available. Further molecular testing, including NGS of fresh or paraffin-embedded tumor tissue, should also be performed and cover the common MAPK pathway mutations (*BRAF*, *ARAF*, *NRAS*, *KRAS*, *MAP2K1/2*) and other related pathway mutations (eg, *PIK3CA*, *CSF1R*). Gene fusion assays using an RNA-based molecular panel is also recommended and should cover *BRAF*, *ALK*, *RET*, and *NTRK1* rearrangements. If clinically indicated in cases without the usual MAPK pathway mutations, FISH for *BRAF*, *ALK*, *RET*, or *NTRK1* fusions may be performed. If there is a clinical concern for ALK rearrangement or if fusion panel testing is not available, ALK IHC and FISH studies can be performed. Molecular testing for somatic mutations and fusions should be conducted in a stepwise manner or in parallel, depending on clinical need and institutional protocols. The frequency of suspected molecular lesions should drive the order of testing if a stepwise algorithm is chosen. Mutational analysis of the peripheral blood is also an option if a biopsy is not possible due to location or risk factors.[110] Peripheral blood testing may be informative in multisystem disease. Determination of these molecular alterations should be performed, where available, as this aids both in the diagnosis of ECD and treatment decision-making.[15] For more information, see *Pathologic Analysis of Histiocytic Disorders* and *Histopathologic Characterization of ECD* in this Discussion.

***Histopathologic Characterization of ECD***

On H&E stain, ECD tumor tissue often demonstrates foamy mononucleated histiocytes with a small nucleus and an inconspicuous nucleoli, surrounding fibrosis, xanthogranulomatosis, and Touton giant cells.[2,3,15,24] Additionally, the cytoplasm is classically abundant, amorphous, and lipid-laden. Inflammatory cells, including reactive lymphocytes, neutrophils, and plasma cells are the common background cells with eosinophils being rare. Dense fibrosis may also be observed.[15] On IHC, neoplastic histiocytes are typically CD68-positive, CD163-positive, CD14-positive, factor XIIIa-positive, CD1a-negative, and CD207 (Langerin)-negative.[2,24,91] Typical features of the stroma as well as the histiocytic and reactive infiltrate have been found to vary depending on disease location (ie, bone, central nervous system [CNS], lung, skin, orbit, retroperitoneum, cardiac tissue).[111] CD1a-positive, S100-positive, and Langerin-positive findings can help distinguish LCH from ECD.[1,91] The possible presence of S100-positive cells with emperipolesis may lead to challenges in distinguishing ECD from RDD.[1 15]

Somatic mutations contributing to ECD partially overlap with that of LCH.[2] *BRAF* V600E activating mutations are present in 38% to 68% of ECD cases.[6,7,91,97,110,111] Other prevalent gene mutations in ECD include *MAP2K1/2, ARAF*, *NRAS*, *KRAS,* and *PIK3CA*.[7,8,110,111] *PIK3CA* activating mutations are more common in ECD than LCH. Moreover, *CSF1R* mutations and *BRAF, ALK*, and *NTRK1* fusions are found in a small number of ECD cases.[8,53,110] ECD co-occurring with RDD is most commonly driven by mutations in *MAP2K1/2*.[111,112] Extracutaneous or disseminated juvenile xanthogranuloma with mutations in the *MAPK* pathway has similar histopathology and phenotype to ECD and thus

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may be considered ECD.[1] *BRAF* V600E (VE1) should be evaluated using IHC, but allele-specific PCR for *BRAF* V600E may be considered; see *Histopathologic Characterization of LCH* above. As with LCH, panel testing should include other mutations in the MAPK and other related pathways. For complete recommendations regarding pathologic analysis of ECD cases, see the *Principles of Pathology* in the algorithm.

**Treatment of ECD**

Treatment of ECD mainly consists of systemic therapy, though observation may be considered for patients with asymptomatic disease not involving critical organs such as the heart, brain, and CNS.

Preferred regimens for ECD in the first- or subsequent-line setting include vemurafenib for *BRAF* V600E-mutated disease and cobimetinib for patients with other MAP kinase pathway mutations, no other detectable/actionable mutation present, or if testing is not available. As discussed in the previous section covering targeted therapy in LCH, the phase II VE-BASKET study showed that vemurafenib is highly effective in patients with *BRAF* V600E-mutated ECD that is associated with near universal responses.[67] Results from the VE-BASKET study led to the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA) approval of vemurafenib for treatment of ECD. However, the FDA-approved dose (960 mg twice daily) is associated with significant toxicity that very often results in discontinuation, dose interruption, or dose modification.[67] A retrospective study carried out at an NCCN Member Institution including 23 patients with *BRAF* V600E-mutated ECD showed that progressive disease did not occur in patients (n = 14) who received vemurafenib administered at half the FDA-approved dose (ie, 480 mg twice daily), though half of these patients still required further dose reduction, with 29% discontinuing vemurafenib treatment due to adverse events.[113] Additionally, the MEK inhibitor, cobimetinib, demonstrated efficacy in ECD in the phase II study by Diamond et al[12] discussed previously where 18 patients (12 of which had ECD) demonstrated consistent and durable responses when treated with this drug (see *Systemic Therapy for LCH* above for more information about this trial).

Other recommended regimens for patients with ECD include dabrafenib for *BRAF* V600E mutated disease and trametinib for MAP kinase pathway mutation or no other detectable/actionable mutation. Irrespective of mutation, cladribine, pegylated interferon alpha-2a and alpha-2b, sirolimus plus prednisone, oral methotrexate, or anakinra may also be used. The efficacy of dabrafenib for *BRAF* V600E-mutated ECD is supported by a retrospective single-center French study[114] and a multicenter case series.[115] As with LCH, dabrafenib appears to be less toxic than vemurafenib.[115] As described above for LCH (see *Systemic Therapy for LCH*), in a phase II trial in which 67% of patients were diagnosed with ECD, a 72% CR rate was demonstrated for cobimetinib.[12] These promising results were not limited to patients with a mutation in the MAPK pathway. A small study supports use of the MEK inhibitor trametinib for treatment of non-LCH histiocytic neoplasms, regardless of molecular profile.[116]

Prior to the availability of targeted therapy for ECD, the largest body of evidence supported the use of interferon alpha-2a and pegylated interferon alpha for the treatment of ECD.[91] In a multicenter, prospective, nonrandomized study conducted in Europe (N = 53), interferon alpha or pegylated interferon alpha treatment was associated with improved survival (HR, 0.32; 95% CI, 0.14–0.70; *P* = .006).[105] A single-center report from France (N = 8) showed that interferon alpha was most effective for relieving exophthalmos, bilateral hydronephrosis, and xanthelasma related to ECD, and was associated with a decrease in C-reactive protein.[117] This report cautioned against the use of interferon alpha in patients with ECD involving the CNS and/or cardiovascular system. However, a later single-center study from

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France reported outcomes for a larger cohort (N = 24) that showed high-dose interferon alpha was associated with a clinical and/or radiologic improvement in 46% of patients, including those with severe ECD with CNS or cardiovascular involvement.[118] Interferon alpha as a treatment option for ECD is also supported by several case reports.[119,120] Interferon alpha has been discontinued in the United States and is therefore not recommended in the NCCN Guidelines. Pegylated interferon alpha, which has a more favorable toxicity profile compared to interferon alpha, is recommended as a substitute based on the evidence discussed above. Peginterferon alfa-2a is the only peginterferon alfa available for clinical use in the United States, and it may be substituted for peginterferon alfa-2b.[121-123]

Evidence supporting other systemic therapy options for treatment of ECD is primarily based on retrospective single-center studies and case series. A retrospective study conducted at an NCCN Member Institution evaluated the efficacy of cladribine as first- or subsequent-line treatment of ECD (n = 21).[124] The clinical ORR was 52%, with CR and PR observed in 4% and 46% of patients, respectively. Progressive disease was observed in 30% of patients. The response was durable, with the median DOR of 9 months in the responders. Toxicities associated with cladribine were relatively minimal. In a single-center study from Italy including 10 patients with ECD, sirolimus combined with prednisone was associated with an ORR of 60% (all PRs).[125] Oral methotrexate as first- or subsequent-line treatment of ECD was evaluated in a retrospective study conducted at an NCCN Member Institution (N = 13).[126] Oral methotrexate was administered either alone or in combination with prednisone or infliximab and was associated with a clinical ORR of 23% (all PRs). Progressive disease occurred in 70%. Despite the low ORR, methotrexate-based treatment was well-tolerated, and response was durable in some of those who responded to the treatment, especially those with ocular ECD. Finally, two small single-center studies showed good efficacy with the IL-1 receptor antagonist anakinra as a treatment option for ECD.[127,128]

As with LCH, other targeted therapies can also be selected for patients with ECD based on the respective molecular alteration. Crizotinib, alectinib, brigatinib, ceritinib, and lorlatinib are options for patients with *ALK* rearrangements while selpercatinib is recommended for ECD with rearrangements in *RET*.[53,129] Pexidartinib for ECD with activating mutations in *CSF1R*, and larotrectinib, entrectinib, repotrectinib for ECD with *NTRK* fusions, are all reasonable systemic therapy options when clinically indicated.[53,83-86,130] Since mutations in *PIK3CA* are fairly common in ECD[7], mTOR inhibitors such as sirolimus and everolimus should also be considered when clinically indicated.[87] Of note, lower doses are to be considered upon starting targeted agents.

### Follow-up

Similar to LCH, follow-up assessment for patients with ECD depends on extent of disease and organ involvement. FDG-PET/CT should be used to monitor disease response once treatment is initiated. Organ-specific cross-sectional imaging (CT or MRI) should also be utilized, and ongoing evaluation for pituitary hormone abnormalities should be incorporated. Regular skin examination and ECG is recommended for patients treated with *BRAF* inhibitors with regular skin and retinal examination and ECG also being recommended for patients treated with MEK inhibitors. For further information, see *Follow-up for ECD* in the algorithm.

## Rosai-Dorfman Disease

RDD is another rare histiocytic disorder that mainly affects children but is also diagnosed in adults. In RDD, accumulation of abnormal histiocytes in lymph node sinuses, lymphatic vessels of internal organs, and other extranodal sites is observed. Previously RDD was considered

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a benign and self-limiting condition; however, more recent data has contributed to RDD being officially recognized as a blood cancer by the World Health Organization (WHO) in 2022.[131] This disease is more common in men than in women and often affects individuals of African ancestry.[24,132] Cause is unknown but may be associated with familial, autoimmune, and/or malignant processes. It is a heterogeneous condition with a presentation that may be classified as single or regional lymph node-involved or localized to the skin and other organs. Prognosis is generally very good but becomes worse as the number of involved nodal groups increases.[132] Recurrent disease is reported to occur in about one in three patients with RDD.[133]

Extranodal involvement occurs often in RDD, with common sites of involvement including the skin, soft tissue, upper respiratory tract, multifocal bone (mostly osteolytic lesions), retroperitoneum, and eye/retro-orbital tissue with lymphadenopathy.[3,132,133] Bilateral massive cervical lymphadenopathy also commonly occurs and is often painless, though involvement of the mediastinal, inguinal, and axillary lymph nodes may also occur.[132] Skin-involved RDD often presents as subcutaneous masses and, less often, as cutaneous lesions.[133] Involvement of the nasal cavity, paranasal sinuses, and parotid gland have also been reported.[24,132,134] CNS involvement may also occur but is generally rare.[132,133,135,136] CNS-involved RDD may mimic meningioma.[132]

RDD may co-occur with Hodgkin and non-Hodgkin lymphoma, other histiocytic disorders, cutaneous clear-cell sarcoma, and following myelodysplastic syndrome and allogeneic stem transplant for precursor B-cell acute lymphoblastic leukemia.[24,132,133] Germline mutations in *SLC29A3*, which is associated with Faisalabad histiocytosis, H syndrome, and pigmented hypertrichotic dermatosis with insulin-dependent diabetes, have been found in cases of familial RDD.[132] About 20% of patients with H syndrome have RDD.[137] Germline mutation in the *FAS* gene *TNFRSF*, which is associated with autoimmune lymphoproliferative syndrome (ALPS) type I, has also been found in RDD cases.[132] Immunologic diseases associated with RDD include systemic lupus erythematous, idiopathic juvenile arthritis, and autoimmune hemolytic anemia.[132]

### Diagnosis of RDD

Diagnosis of RDD involves a clinical and radiologic examination, as well as histopathologic analysis. Essential workup for RDD includes a comprehensive H&P with special attention to the common sites of involvement: peripheral lymphadenopathy, subcutaneous nodules, and extranodal sites (skin [HEENT], soft tissue, upper respiratory tract, bone, retroperitoneum, orbits, and spleen). Evaluation of the endocrine system and any intrathoracic/pulmonary, cardiovascular, gastrointestinal, musculoskeletal genital, renal, and cutaneous symptoms is recommended. Neurologic and psychological assessments are also encouraged as needed. History of inherited conditions predisposing to RDD (eg, ALPS), malignancies and other neoplasia associated with RDD (eg, Hodgkin and non-Hodgkin lymphoma, other histiocytic disorders), and other autoimmune disorders (eg, systemic lupus erythematous, idiopathic juvenile arthritis) should be evaluated based on clinical symptoms and family history. Family history should also be considered if parents are consanguineous, possess an autoimmune disease, or are of Turkish/Pakistani or Middle Eastern ancestry.

Full-body FDG-PET/CT is also recommended as part of the baseline evaluation of RDD. A single-center retrospective study including 109 FDG-PET/CT scans in 27 patients with RDD showed that PET/CT detected lesions not recognized by anatomic cross-sectional imaging in 30% of patients with available prior CT or MRI (n = 20).[138] Results of

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PET/CT scans also led to changes in treatment in 41% of patients. Cross-sectional imaging can reveal dermatologic involvement in the form of lobular soft-tissue lesions in the subcutaneous space.[3] Pulmonary involvement in RDD tends to manifest as mediastinal lymphadenopathy, airway disease, pleural effusion, and cystic and interstitial lung disease.[139] Extranodal retroperitoneal involvement, if present, would appear in radiologic findings as wispy infiltration and/or renal hilar masses.[3] MRI of the head tends to be superior for evaluation of the sinuses and orbits, compared to PET/CT.[3] MRI of the brain and spine is useful for identification of asymptomatic neurologic involvement.[132] Based on symptoms and organ involvement, further imaging of the chest, abdomen, and pelvis as well as the sinuses with a CT scan can be performed as well as imaging of the brain, orbit, spine, and sella turcica with or without pituitary evaluation in the event of AVP deficiency using MRI. Imaging studies should be performed with contrast unless contrast is contraindicated. PFTs and TTE may be needed in the event of pulmonary RDD. Thyroid and testicular US can also be performed if clinically indicated. Like LCH and ECD, dermatology and ophthalmology evaluations should be considered in appropriate patients due to toxicities associated with BRAF and MEK inhibitors.[11-13] The complete recommendations for evaluation of RDD are provided in the algorithm and are adapted from recommendations from an expert consensus group[132] (see *Rosai-Dorfman Disease: Workup/Evaluation* in the algorithm.

Additionally, laboratory evaluation should be included in the essential workup with CBC, comprehensive metabolic panel, coagulation studies, and an evaluation of C-reactive protein, uric acid, LDH, and serum immunoglobulins being recommended.[132] If autoimmune disease is suspected based on clinical examination, then laboratory evaluation should also include antinuclear antigen, antineutrophil cytoplasmic antibodies, rheumatoid factor, and HLA-B27. The ALPS panel is clinically indicated in patients with autoimmunity and lymphadenopathy. Laboratory evaluation in patients with anemia should include a Coombs test, haptoglobin, reticulocyte count, and blood smear. Lumbar puncture should be carried out if there are brain lesions that cannot be biopsied due to location. If a patient has an unexplained, abnormal CBC, bone marrow aspirate and biopsy are recommended.[132] As with LCH and ECD, biopsy of tumor tissue is recommended for diagnosis and molecular testing (both IHC and NGS).[110] If biopsy is not feasible, then peripheral blood analysis is reasonable. The minimum IHC panel performed should include: CD68 or CD163, S100, CD1a, and cyclin D1; however, caution should be applied to cyclin D1 as it could also be detected in concurrent lymphocytic or histiocytic neoplasm. *BRAF* V600E (VE1) IHC should also be included in the analysis. NGS of tumor tissue should evaluate mutations in the MAPK pathway and other related pathways. Gene fusion assays should also be performed while germline mutation testing is optional in these patients. For more information, see *Pathologic Analysis of Histiocytic Disorders* and *Histopathologic Characterization of RDD* in this Discussion.

***Histopathologic Characterization of RDD***

Compared to LCH and ECD, histopathologic analysis of RDD can be challenging, as RDD tissue tends to contain relatively few lesional cells.[133] Large histiocytic cells with round and hypochromatic nuclei, distinct and central nucleoli, and an abundant amount of pale cytoplasm are required for diagnosis or RDD.[1] Emperipolesis, specifically intracytoplasmic leukocytes, is a frequently observed feature of RDD.[1-3,24,132,133] However, emperipolesis may be observed less often in extranodal lesion tissue.[132] Abundant plasma cells in the medullary cords and around the venules is a hallmark of nodal RDD along with polyclonal IgG4.[15,132] Other pathologic hallmarks include the accumulation of CD68-positive, CD163-positive, CD14-positive, and S100-positive histiocytic cells.[1-3,132,133] RDD histiocytes tend to be CD1a-

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and CD207-negative, which helps to distinguish from LCH.[132] Cyclin D1 expression by the abnormal histiocytes, OCT2-positivity, and increased IgG4-positive plasma cells in the background inflammatory infiltrate, may also be found.[140,141] OCT2 IHC was found in a recent study to potentially be helpful in select cases to confirm a suspected diagnosis of RDD along with other common diagnostic markers.[142]

Unlike LCH and ECD, *BRAF* V600E activating mutations are not commonly observed in patients with RDD.[3,24,132] However, *KRAS*, *MAP21K, ARAF*, and *NRAS* mutations have been found in patients with RDD.[8,132,133,143] As with LCH and ECD, NGS panel testing should evaluate mutations in the MAPK pathway as well as other related pathways. Even though some of these mutations (eg, *BRAF* V600E) are less common in RDD, a comprehensive panel test is helpful for distinguishing RDD from other histiocytic neoplasms. Germline testing for *SLC29A3*, if familial RDD is suspected, and *TNFRSF* should also be considered if clinically indicated. Complete recommendations regarding pathologic analysis of RDD cases can be found in the *Principles of Pathology* in the algorithm.

### Treatment of RDD

Observation is a reasonable treatment strategy for patients with asymptomatic and mild RDD, as spontaneous remission has been reported to occur in 40% of these patients.[132,133] Surgical resection is also a reasonable curative option for those with isolated disease or for the debulking of symptomatic disease of the CNS, sinuses, or airways.[132,133] Patients with extranodal disease impacting critical organs and those with serious RDD-related complications require treatment with systemic therapies (see below). RT should only be used for palliative purposes in patients with multifocal symptomatic disease.[132] Case reports have shown some efficacy for RT when used to treat refractory disease in the eyelid and soft tissue of the cheek,[144] as well as RDD lesions causing airway obstruction.[145] RT dosing for RDD is not well-established, but 30 to 50 Gy may be used.[132,145]

#### *Systemic Therapy*

Systemic therapy is recommended for first-line treatment of symptomatic unresectable or multifocal disease and for treatment of relapsed/refractory disease. There is a dearth of research in this area, and some systemic therapy options that may be used for treating RDD are extrapolated from ECD.[133] Preferred regimens for the treatment of RDD include cobimetinib for patients with MAP kinase pathway mutation, no other detectable/actionable mutation, or if testing is not available. Cladribine, cytarabine, oral methotrexate, and prednisone or other corticosteroids are also preferred regimens irrespective of mutation.

Cobimetinib was evaluated in a study of 16 patients with RDD, the largest reported series of patients with RDD to date, 50% of whom had either detectable *KRAS* or *MEK* somatic alterations. Positive outcomes were observed with cobimetinib in this cohort, most notably in those with demonstrated *KRAS*- or *MEK*-variant RDD.[146] Patients with genetic alterations in *KRAS* or *MEK* had a significantly enhanced ORR (88% vs. 38%) and PFS at 1 year (100% vs. 29%) as well as deeper responses (71% complete responses vs. 0%) compared to those without these alterations.[146]

A retrospective study, conducted at Mayo Clinic (N = 57), revealed that corticosteroid treatment (most often prednisone) was associated with a 56% ORR in the first-line setting, with relapse occurring in 53% of patients, and a 67% ORR in the subsequent-line setting.[133] This study also showed that cladribine was the most commonly used systemic therapy for treatment of recurrent disease and was associated with a 67% ORR.[133,147] Case reports support use of cytarabine and oral methotrexate for treatment of RDD.[148-151] A case report describing

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treatment of a pediatric patient with RDD supports use of methotrexate delivered intravenously,[152] although oral administration is generally used.[153,154] Steroids may be used to treat patients with symptomatic nodal or cutaneous disease, for unresectable or multifocal extranodal disease, and/or for relief of symptoms from CNS- or orbit-involved disease.[132,133] As described above, the Mayo Clinic study supports use of prednisone for treatment of RDD, both in the first- and subsequent-line settings.[133] This study showed that prednisone combined with 6-mercaptopurine and either methotrexate or azathioprine was also associated with disease response in the subsequent-line setting in patients with subcutaneous and lymph node involvement, and a PR was achieved in one patient who was treated with cyclophosphamide, vincristine, and prednisone.

Other recommended regimens include trametinib for MAP kinase pathway mutation, no other detectable/actionable mutation, or if testing is not available, or vinblastine plus prednisone, IV or SC methotrexate, or lenalidomide, irrespective of mutation. Evidence supporting use of targeted agents for RDD is evolving, particularly for MEK inhibitors, and some options may be used based on extrapolation of evidence for use in ECD and LCH. The MEK inhibitor trametinib is an option, regardless of molecular profile, including in those without *BRAF* V600E mutations.[116,155]

Prednisone combined with vinblastine is also supported by a case report describing treatment of a pediatric patient with RDD,[156] but this regimen is associated with increased risk of neuropathy in adults.[77] Optimal duration of steroid treatment is unknown at this time; treating to optimal response, followed by a slow taper, is a reasonable strategy.[132] Adverse effects from steroids should be carefully monitored, though these are generally well-tolerated.[133] Additionally, two case studies demonstrated that lenalidomide was potentially effective in treating patients with RDD that had received previous therapy.[157,158]

Just as with LCH and ECD, targeted systemic therapy options may be recommended in certain circumstances.[53,83-85] These include: crizotinib for *ALK* rearrangements, selpercatinib for *RET* rearrangements, pexidartinib for activating mutations in *CSF1R*, larotrectinib, repotrectinib, and entrectinib for *NTRK* fusions, everolimus for PIK3CA mutations, and sirolimus for those associated with ALPS and/ or PIK3CA mutation.[53,83-86,159] Rituximab and thalidomide may also be useful irrespective of mutation for IgG4-related nodal and immune-cytopenia disease or for cutaneous involvement, respectively.[151,160] For more information on systemic therapy options for RDD treatment, see HIST-D 4 of 6 *Principles of Systemic Therapy for RDD* in the algorithm.

### Follow-up

As with LCH and ECD, follow-up assessment for patients with RDD depends on extent of disease and organ involvement and includes post-treatment surveillance and imaging of involved sites. A complete list of recommendations for surveillance following treatment of RDD can be found in the algorithm (see *Rosai-Dorfman Disease: Follow-up* in the algorithm).

## Supportive Care for Patients

The management of histiocytic neoplasms, as well as the disorders themselves, can lead to various toxicities and chronic symptoms.[15,33,161,162] BRAF and MEK Inhibitors are not always tolerated at the full doses that are approved for melanoma. Therefore, for patients without CNS involvement it may be reasonable to start at half the approved dose and then modify the dose over time based on tolerance and toxicities. These drugs can lead to cutaneous toxicities, such as the acneiform rash that can occur with MEK inhibitors. In addition, there is

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an increased risk of cutaneous squamous cell carcinoma with BRAF inhibitor use. Therefore, routine dermatologic examination is recommended. Tyrosine kinase inhibitors may also be poorly tolerated at full doses, and it may be reasonable to start with one or two dose reductions and then adjust the dose based on response.

Separate from drug toxicities, patients often have other quality of life issues related to chronic pain, fatigue, depression, and anxiety. Patients with histiocytic disorders (especially ECD and LDH) often struggle with chronic generalized pain and fatigue that is out of proportion to the disease involvement. The oral stimulant methylphenidate can be used and appears safe for the long-term use in patients with cases of severe fatigue. Many of these patients also fit the criteria for myalgic encephalomyelitis/chronic fatigue syndrome. Also, some patients have residual pain at the site of a tumor bed despite complete resection (especially in the case of bone lesions from LCH) and much of the chronic pain may not respond well to available analgesics. There is a high prevalence of depression and anxiety that compounds these symptoms further. All of which can worsen the health-related quality of life of these patients significantly. It is important for clinicians to acknowledge these symptoms fully and refer the patients to appropriate supportive care services. Depending on the specific manifestations of their disease, patients should also continue to closely follow up with their pulmonary/neurology/endocrinology specialist during surveillance.

## Summary

The NCCN Guidelines for Histiocytic Neoplasms provide an evidence- and consensus-based approach for the diagnosis and treatment of adult histiocytic neoplasms, which are relatively rare heterogeneous hematologic disorders. LCH, ECD, and RDD are the most common, but these diseases, given their rarity, overlap, and co-occurrence with other types of neoplasms, pose a diagnostic challenge. Appropriate diagnosis is necessary to achieve the best clinical outcomes with immunophenotyping and molecular marker profiling being critical components to differential diagnosis. Additionally, molecular testing provides guidance on the most effective systemic therapy options with many patients having complete recoveries. Research continues to improve therapeutic approaches, especially to in the context of targeting abnormal cells while simultaneously sparing normal tissue, and the NCCN Panel continues to encourage patients to participate in well-designed clinical trials in order to enable future advancement for management of these diseases.

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Discussion in progress



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